# Chapter 20 — Cheat Sheets and Glossary

This chapter compresses Chapters 1–19 into pages you can scan in a minute: one **cheat sheet** per area, a **feature-by-version table** for Java 17 → 25, everyday build and test **commands**, an **interview question index**, a **"where next"** guide, and an alphabetical **glossary** of 685 terms (§20.19) — every technical term on the sheets is defined there once, linked to the section that teaches it. References like **§10.5** mean Chapter 10, section 5. To revise, cover the right-hand column of a sheet and say the answer before you look.

**Every concrete value on the sheets is tested.** Primitive ranges, the `Integer` cache, the string pool, collection behaviours, stream results, `BigDecimal` and `java.time` edge cases, concurrency results and more are asserted by `code/ch20/CheatsheetChecks.java` (package `ch20`), compiled with `javac --release 25` and run on JDK 26 by the book's runner (`bash tools_run_java.sh java`). A failed check throws `AssertionError`. Real output:

```
OK   20.1 syntax, types, primitives           29 checks
OK   20.2 operators & precedence              16 checks
OK   20.3 control flow & patterns             12 checks
OK   20.4 methods & arrays                    16 checks
OK   20.5 OOP                                 13 checks
OK   20.6 core APIs                           45 checks
OK   20.7 exceptions                          12 checks
OK   20.8 generics                             7 checks
OK   20.9 collections                         28 checks
OK   20.10 functional interfaces & Optional   12 checks
OK   20.11 streams & collectors               18 checks
OK   20.12 I/O & NIO.2                        11 checks
OK   20.13 concurrency                        13 checks
OK   20.14 JVM                                9 checks
OK   20.15 modern Java 17-25                  9 checks
all 250 checks passed on Java 26
```

The helper is three small methods — `eq(actual, expected, label)`, `yes(condition, label)` and `throwsA(ExceptionType.class, code, label)` — because Java's own `assert` keyword is switched off unless you run `java -ea` (§19.1). A few lines as a taste:

```
Integer i1 = 127, i2 = 127, i3 = 128, i4 = 128;
eq(i1 == i2, true, "Integer cache -128..127");
eq(i3 == i4, false, "outside the cache: different objects");
throwsA(IllegalStateException.class, () -> emps.stream().collect(Collectors.toMap(Emp::dept, Emp::name)),
        "toMap duplicate key throws");
eq(LocalDate.of(2024, 1, 31).plusMonths(1), LocalDate.of(2024, 2, 29), "plusMonths clamps to month end");
```

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## 20.1 Syntax, types and primitive ranges

**Program shapes** (§1.5, §1.10, §4.9):

```
// Classic: file Hello.java, class name = file name
public class Hello {
    public static void main(String[] args) { System.out.println("Hi " + args.length); }
}

// Java 25 compact source file (JEP 512): no class declaration, instance main, java.lang.IO
void main() { IO.println("Hi"); }
```

| Command | Does | Since |
|---|---|---|
| `javac Hello.java` → `java Hello` | compile to `Hello.class`, then run it on the JVM | 1.0 |
| `javac -d out $(find src -name '*.java')` → `java -cp out pkg.Main` | compile a tree into `out/`, run with a class path | — |
| `java Hello.java` | compile in memory and run a single source file | 11 |
| `java Main.java` (other files next to it) | launch a multi-file source program | 22 |
| `jshell` | interactive REPL: type expressions, see results | 9 |
| `javap -c Hello` | disassemble bytecode | — |

**Basic rules** (§2.1): statements end with `;`; blocks use `{}`; Java is case-sensitive; identifiers start with a letter, `_` or `$` (a lone `_` is not a name — since 22 it means "unnamed"); comments are `//`, `/* */` and `/** Javadoc */` (Markdown `///` doc comments since 23). Naming: `ClassName`, `methodAndVariable`, `CONSTANT_NAME`, `com.example.pkg`. Contextual keywords — `var`, `record`, `sealed`, `non-sealed`, `permits`, `yield`, `when`, `module` — are keywords only in their positions.

**The eight primitives** (§2.3) — everything else is a reference type (§2.5):

| Type | Bits | Range | Default (fields) | Literal |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `byte` | 8 | −128 … 127 | `0` | `(byte) 1` |
| `short` | 16 | −32 768 … 32 767 | `0` | `(short) 1` |
| `int` | 32 | −2 147 483 648 … 2 147 483 647 (±2.1 × $10^9$) | `0` | `42`, `0x2A`, `0b101010`, `052`, `1_000_000` |
| `long` | 64 | −9 223 372 036 854 775 808 … 9 223 372 036 854 775 807 (±9.2 × $10^{18}$) | `0L` | `42L` |
| `float` | 32 | ±3.4028235 × $10^{38}$, ~7 significant digits | `0.0f` | `3.14f` |
| `double` | 64 | ±1.7976931348623157 × $10^{308}$, ~15–16 digits | `0.0` | `3.14`, `1e-9` |
| `char` | 16 | 0 … 65 535 (unsigned UTF-16 code unit) | `'\u0000'` | `'A'`, `'\n'`, `'\u0041'` |
| `boolean` | — | `true`, `false` | `false` | `true` |

- `Double.MIN_VALUE` (4.9E-324) is the smallest **positive** double; the most negative is `-Double.MAX_VALUE`.
- Fields get defaults (`0`, `false`, `null`); **local variables don't** — reading one before assigning it is a compile error (§2.2).
- Money: `long` cents or `BigDecimal`, never `double` (§2.11).

**Conversions** (§2.7):

| Rule | Example | Result |
|---|---|---|
| Widening is automatic: `byte → short → int → long → float → double`, `char → int` | `long l = 42;` | ok |
| Narrowing needs a cast and keeps the low bits | `(byte) 200` | `-56` |
| Casting a floating value to an integer truncates toward zero | `(int) 3.99` | `3` |
| Arithmetic promotes `byte` / `short` / `char` to `int` | `byte b = 10; b = b + 1;` | compile error |
| Compound assignment hides a cast | `byte b = 10; b += 300;` | `54` |
| `char` is a number | `(int) 'A'`, `(char) ('a' + 1)` | `65`, `'b'` |

**Integer and floating-point facts** (§2.10, §2.11):

| Expression | Value | Why |
|---|---|---|
| `Integer.MAX_VALUE + 1` | `-2147483648` | silent wrap-around; use `Math.addExact` to get an `ArithmeticException` |
| `7 / 2`, `-7 / 2` | `3`, `-3` | integer division truncates toward zero |
| `-7 % 3` / `Math.floorMod(-7, 3)` | `-1` / `2` | `%` takes the dividend's sign |
| `7 / 2.0` | `3.5` | one `double` operand → `double` arithmetic |
| `0.1 + 0.2` | `0.30000000000000004` | binary fractions can't represent 0.1 exactly |
| `1.0 / 0`, `0.0 / 0`, `1 / 0` | `Infinity`, `NaN`, `ArithmeticException` | floats have special values; ints throw |
| `Double.NaN == Double.NaN` | `false` | test with `Double.isNaN` |

**`var`** (Java 10, §2.6): local variables with an initializer only (also in `for` loops and lambda parameters); not for fields, parameters or return types; `var x = null;` and `var a = {1, 2};` don't compile. The type is fixed at compile time — `var` is not dynamic typing.

**Text blocks** (Java 15, §2.12): `"""` + newline opens; common indentation is stripped (the closing `"""` position counts); a closing delimiter on its own line adds a trailing `\n`; `\` at line end joins lines; `\s` keeps a trailing space.

**Console I/O** (§2.13, §13.8): `System.out.println/print/printf`; input with `Scanner(System.in)` (`nextInt`, `nextLine` — beware the leftover newline), `BufferedReader`, or `IO.readln("prompt")` in Java 25. `System.console()` returns `null` without an interactive terminal (IDEs, pipes) — always check it (Java 22–24 briefly returned a JLine-based console even then; 25 reverted).

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## 20.2 Operators and precedence

From highest to lowest (§2.8, §2.9). Operands are always evaluated **left to right**; associativity only decides grouping.

| Level | Operators | Associativity |
|---|---|---|
| 1 Postfix | `x++` `x--` | left |
| 2 Unary | `++x` `--x` `+` `-` `~` `!` `(type)` | right |
| 3 Multiplicative | `*` `/` `%` | left |
| 4 Additive | `+` `-` (and `String` `+`) | left |
| 5 Shift | `<<` `>>` `>>>` | left |
| 6 Relational | `<` `>` `<=` `>=` `instanceof` | left |
| 7 Equality | `==` `!=` | left |
| 8–10 Bitwise | `&` then `^` then `\|` | left |
| 11–12 Logical | `&&` then `\|\|` (short-circuit) | left |
| 13 Ternary | `? :` | right |
| 14 Assignment, lambda | `=` `+=` `-=` `*=` `/=` `%=` `&=` `\|=` `^=` `<<=` `>>=` `>>>=` `->` | right |

Memory hook: **unary → multiply → add → shift → compare → equal → bitwise → logical → ternary → assign.**

| Expression | Value | Lesson |
|---|---|---|
| `2 + 3 * 4` | `14` | `*` before `+` |
| `10 - 4 - 3` | `3` | left-associative |
| `1 + 2 + "3" + 4 + 5` | `"3345"` | numbers add until the first `String`, then everything concatenates |
| `true \|\| false && false` | `true` | `&&` binds tighter than `\|\|` |
| `x & 1 == 0` | compile error for `int x` | `==` binds tighter than `&` — write `(x & 1) == 0` |
| `i = 5; i++ + ++i` | `12` | `5 + 7`; never write this in real code |
| `-8 >> 1`, `-8 >>> 28` | `-4`, `15` | `>>` keeps the sign, `>>>` fills with zeros |
| `5 ^ 3`, `~5`, `1 << 10` | `6`, `-6`, `1024` | XOR, complement (−(n+1)), shift = ×2ⁿ |
| `a = b = c = 7` | all `7` | assignment is right-associative |
| `s != null && s.length() > 0` with `s = null` | `false`, no exception | `&&` stops at the first `false` |
| `o instanceof String str && str.length() == 4` | `true` for `"text"` | pattern variable in scope after `&&` (Java 16) |

`==` on objects compares **references**; use `equals` for content (§6.13, §7.6).

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## 20.3 Control flow, `switch` and patterns

**Branches and loops** (§3.1, §3.8, §3.9):

| Construct | Shape | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| `if` / `else if` / `else` | `if (cond) { … } else { … }` | condition must be `boolean` — `if (1)` doesn't compile |
| Ternary | `cond ? a : b` | an expression; keep it short |
| `for` | `for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)` | index loops |
| Enhanced `for` | `for (String s : list)` | arrays and any `Iterable`; can't remove safely inside |
| `while` / `do … while` | test first / body runs at least once | |
| `break` / `continue` | leave / skip to next iteration of the innermost loop | `break outer;` / `continue outer;` with a label |

**The four `switch` shapes** (§3.2, §3.3, §3.4):

| Shape | Falls through? | Produces a value? | Must be exhaustive? |
|---|---|---|---|
| Statement, `case X:` | **yes** — until `break` | no | no (unless it uses patterns or `null`) |
| Statement, `case X ->` (14) | no | no | no (same exception) |
| Expression, `case X ->` (14) | no | yes; blocks use `yield` | **yes** |
| Expression, `case X:` + `yield` | yes | yes | yes |

```
String type = switch (day) {
    case 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 -> "weekday";
    case 6, 7 -> "weekend";
    default -> { yield "invalid"; }
};
```

Selector types: `int` and smaller (`char`, `byte`, `short`) and their wrappers, `String`, enums — and, with patterns (21), **any reference type**. `long`, `float`, `double` and `boolean` selectors need *primitive patterns*, which are still **preview** in Java 25.

**Pattern matching** (§3.5, §3.6, §3.7):

| Feature | Syntax | Final in |
|---|---|---|
| Type pattern in `instanceof` | `if (o instanceof String s && !s.isEmpty())` | 16 |
| Type pattern in `switch` | `case Integer i ->` | 21 |
| Guard | `case Integer i when i < 0 ->` | 21 |
| `null` label | `case null ->` or `case null, default ->` | 21 |
| Record pattern (nestable) | `case Point(int x, int y) when x == y ->` | 21 |
| `var` in a record pattern | `case Point(var x, var y) ->` | 21 |
| Unnamed pattern / variable | `case Point(var x, _) ->`, `catch (Exception _)`, `for (var _ : list)` | 22 |

Rules to remember: without `case null`, a `null` selector throws `NullPointerException`; the first matching label wins, and a label that can never match (dominated, e.g. `CharSequence` before `String`) is a compile error; a pattern `switch` must be exhaustive — add `default` or cover every permitted subtype of a **sealed** type:

```java
sealed interface Shape permits Circle, Square {}
record Circle(double r) implements Shape {}
record Square(double side) implements Shape {}

static double area(Shape s) {
    return switch (s) {                // no default needed: the compiler knows all subtypes
        case Circle c -> Math.PI * c.r() * c.r();
        case Square q -> q.side() * q.side();
    };
}
```

**Loop pitfalls** (§3.10): off-by-one (`<=` vs `<`), modifying a collection inside for-each (→ `ConcurrentModificationException`), `float` loop counters, `==` on strings in conditions, and infinite `while` loops whose variable never changes.

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## 20.4 Methods and arrays

**Methods** (§4.1–§4.5):

| Topic | Rule |
|---|---|
| Signature | name + parameter types (not the return type, not parameter names) |
| Passing | **always by value**; for objects the value is a copy of the reference — the callee can mutate the object but not rebind the caller's variable |
| Overload resolution | phase 1: exact match or widening; phase 2: boxing/unboxing; phase 3: varargs. `over(5)` with `over(long)`, `over(Integer)`, `over(int...)` picks `long` |
| Varargs | `int... nums` is an `int[]`; must be the last parameter; one per method; zero arguments allowed |
| `return` | a non-`void` method must return on every path |
| Recursion | needs a base case; each call adds a stack frame → `StackOverflowError` if too deep (Java has no tail-call elimination) |
| `static` | called on the class, has no `this` (§5.5) |

**Arrays** (§4.6, §4.7):

```java
int[] a = new int[3];             // [0, 0, 0] — elements get default values
int[] b = {3, 1, 2};              // initializer
String[] names = new String[2];   // [null, null]
int[][] grid = new int[3][4];     // rectangular
int[][] jagged = {{1}, {2, 3}, {}};  // rows of different lengths
a.length                           // a field, not a method; fixed forever
```

Index `0 … length − 1`; anything else → `ArrayIndexOutOfBoundsException`. Arrays are objects: `a.equals(b)` and `==` compare identity; `a.toString()` prints something like `[I@1b6d3586`.

`java.util.Arrays` (§4.8):

| Method | Does | Example result |
|---|---|---|
| `toString(a)` / `deepToString(m)` | print 1D / nested | `[1, 2, 3]`, `[[1], [2, 3], []]` |
| `equals(a, b)` / `deepEquals` | compare contents | `true` for `{3,1,2}` vs `{3,1,2}` |
| `sort(a)`, `sort(a, from, to)`, `sort(T[], cmp)` | sort in place (dual-pivot quicksort for primitives, stable merge sort — TimSort — for objects) | |
| `binarySearch(a, key)` | on a **sorted** array; not found → `-(insertionPoint) - 1` | `binarySearch([1,2,3], 5)` = `-4` |
| `copyOf(a, n)`, `copyOfRange(a, from, to)` | new array, padded with defaults | `copyOf([1,2,3], 5)` = `[1, 2, 3, 0, 0]` |
| `fill(a, v)`, `setAll(a, i -> …)` | set every element | |
| `asList(…)` | fixed-size `List` **view** of the array — `add` throws, `set` writes through | |
| `stream(a)` | `IntStream` / `Stream<T>` | |
| `mismatch(a, b)`, `compare(a, b)` | first differing index / lexicographic order (9) | |

**Command-line arguments**: `args` is never `null` (empty array when none); all elements are `String`s; the program name is not included (§4.9).

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## 20.5 OOP: classes, interfaces, records, enums and sealed types

**Access modifiers** (§5.6):

| Modifier | Same class | Same package | Subclass (other package) | Everywhere |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `private` | ✓ | | | |
| *(none)* package-private | ✓ | ✓ | | |
| `protected` | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ (through inheritance) | |
| `public` | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |

Top-level classes can only be `public` or package-private; one `public` top-level class per file, named like the file.

**Constructors and initialisation** (§5.3, §5.10):

- If you write no constructor, the compiler adds a no-argument one; write any constructor and it doesn't.
- `this(...)` calls another constructor of the same class, `super(...)` the parent's; if you write neither, `super()` is inserted. Since **Java 25** (JEP 513) statements that don't use `this` — validation, computing arguments, assigning the class's own fields — may appear **before** `super(...)` / `this(...)`.
- Order: static fields and `static {}` blocks run **once**, in source order, when the class is initialised → for each `new`: parent constructor → instance field initialisers and `{}` blocks in source order → the rest of the constructor body.

**`static` and `final`** (§5.5, §5.8): `static` = one per class, shared; a static method has no `this`. `final` variable = assigned once; `final` method = can't be overridden; `final` class = can't be extended. `final` on a reference doesn't freeze the object.

**Inheritance and overriding** (§6.1–§6.4):

| Overriding rule | Detail |
|---|---|
| Same signature | otherwise it's an overload; use `@Override` to let the compiler check |
| Return type | same or a subtype (covariant) |
| Access | same or wider (`protected` → `public` ok, not the reverse) |
| Checked exceptions | same, narrower or none — never new or broader |
| Not overridable | `private`, `static` (hidden instead), `final` methods; constructors |
| Dispatch | instance methods use the object's run-time class; fields and static methods use the compile-time type |

```
class Base    { static String who() { return "Base"; }    String me() { return "Base"; }
                String call() { return me() + "/" + who(); } }
class Derived extends Base { static String who() { return "Derived"; }
                @Override String me() { return "Derived"; } }
new Derived().call()   // "Derived/Base"
```

**Choosing a type** (§6.12):

| Need | Use | Key facts |
|---|---|---|
| Mutable object with identity and lifecycle | **class** (`final` unless designed for extension) | full control of encapsulation |
| Shared state/code for a family of related classes | **abstract class** | fields, constructors, any access; single inheritance; can't be instantiated (§6.5) |
| A capability many unrelated types can have | **interface** | many per class; `abstract`, `default` (8), `static` (8), `private` (9) methods; fields are `public static final` constants; no instance state (§6.6) |
| Immutable data where equal values are interchangeable | **record** (16) | private final fields, canonical constructor, accessors `x()`, `equals`/`hashCode`/`toString`; implicitly `final`; extends `Record`; no extra instance fields; compact constructor for validation (§6.8) |
| A fixed set of instances known at compile time | **enum** | fields, constructors (private), methods, per-constant bodies; `values()`, `valueOf`, `ordinal()`; `EnumSet`/`EnumMap` (§6.9) |
| A closed set of variants | **sealed** interface/class (17) + records | `permits` lists subtypes; each is `final`, `sealed` or `non-sealed`; exhaustive `switch` without `default` (§6.7) |

```
record Range(int lo, int hi) {
    Range {                                     // compact constructor
        if (lo > hi) throw new IllegalArgumentException(lo + " > " + hi);
    }
}
new Point(1, 2).equals(new Point(1, 2))         // record Point(int x, int y): true;  toString() = "Point[x=1, y=2]"
```

**Nested types** (§6.10, §6.11):

| Kind | Declared | Has an outer instance? | Typical use |
|---|---|---|---|
| Static nested class | `static class Node` inside a class | no | helpers, builders, `Map.Entry`-like types — the default choice |
| Inner class | `class Itr` inside a class | yes (`Outer.this`) | iterators that read the outer object's fields |
| Local class | inside a method body | yes if in an instance method | one-off helper with a name |
| Anonymous class | `new Interface() { … }` | yes if in an instance method | one-off implementation with state or several methods |
| Lambda | `x -> …` | captures effectively final locals | single-method (functional) interfaces |

Nested records, enums and interfaces are implicitly `static`.

**`Object` methods contract** (§6.13): `equals` must be reflexive, symmetric, transitive, consistent, and `false` for `null`; equal objects **must** have equal `hashCode`s; override both or neither (`Objects.equals`, `Objects.hash` help). `toString` defaults to `ClassName@hexHash`. Immutability recipe (§5.9): `final` class, `private final` fields, no setters, defensive copies in and out (`List.copyOf`), don't leak `this` from the constructor. Design-level treatment: LLD handbook.

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## 20.6 Core APIs: String, numbers, dates

**Strings** (§7.1, §7.2) are immutable; every "modifying" method returns a new `String`.

| Fact | Value |
|---|---|
| `"java" == "java"` (two literals) | `true` — both are the pooled object |
| `"java" == new String("java")` | `false` — `new` always makes a new object |
| `"java" == new String("java").intern()` | `true` |
| `"java" == part + "va"` (run time, `part = "ja"`) | `false`; `"ja" + "va"` (constants) is folded → `true` |
| `"Java".substring(1, 3)` | `"av"` — end index exclusive |
| `"a,b,,".split(",").length` / `split(",", -1)` | `2` / `4` — trailing empties dropped unless limit is negative |
| `"a.b".replace(".", "-")` / `replaceAll(".", "-")` | `"a-b"` / `"---"` — `replaceAll` takes a **regex** |
| `" ".isBlank()` / `" ".isEmpty()` | `true` / `false` |
| `compareTo` | negative, zero or positive — not necessarily −1/1 |

Everyday methods: `length`, `charAt`, `indexOf` (−1 if absent), `contains`, `startsWith`/`endsWith`, `substring`, `strip` (Unicode-aware; prefer to `trim`), `toLowerCase(Locale.ROOT)`, `equalsIgnoreCase`, `split`, `String.join`, `repeat` (11), `lines` (11), `formatted` (15), `chars`, `codePoints`.

**Builders** (§7.3): `StringBuilder` (mutable, not synchronised — use it for loops: `append`, `insert`, `reverse`, `deleteCharAt`, `setLength(0)`); `StringBuffer` (synchronised, legacy); `StringJoiner` / `String.join` / `Collectors.joining` for delimited lists. `s += x` in a loop is $O(n^2)$.

**Formatting** (§7.4): `String.format(Locale.US, "%5.2f|%-4s|%04d|%,d", 3.14159, "ab", 42, 1234567)` → `" 3.14|ab  |0042|1,234,567"`. Conversions `%s %d %f %e %x %c %b %n %%`; flags `-` left, `0` pad, `,` grouping, `+` sign; `%2$s` argument index. Always pass a `Locale` when the output is parsed by machines.

**`Math`** (§7.5):

| Call | Result | Note |
|---|---|---|
| `Math.round(2.5)`, `Math.round(-2.5)` | `3`, `-2` | ties toward +∞; returns `long` for `double` |
| `Math.rint(2.5)` | `2.0` | ties to even |
| `Math.floorDiv(-7, 2)`, `floorMod(-7, 3)` | `-4`, `2` | round toward −∞ |
| `Math.abs(Integer.MIN_VALUE)` | `-2147483648` | overflow! `absExact` throws |
| `Math.clamp(15, 0, 10)` | `10` | Java 21 |
| `addExact`, `multiplyExact`, `toIntExact`, `powExact` (25) | throw `ArithmeticException` on overflow | |
| `Math.random()` | `double` in [0.0, 1.0) | prefer `RandomGenerator` |

**Wrappers and autoboxing** (§7.6):

| Fact | Detail |
|---|---|
| `Integer a = 127, b = 127; a == b` | `true` — `Integer.valueOf` caches **`-128 … 127`** (also `Short`, `Byte`, `Long`, `Character` ≤ 127, both `Boolean`s) |
| `Integer c = 128, d = 128; c == d` | `false` — always compare wrappers with `equals` |
| `int x = (Integer) null` | `NullPointerException` on unboxing |
| `list.remove(1)` vs `list.remove(Integer.valueOf(1))` | removes **index** 1 vs the **value** 1 |
| `Integer.parseInt("ff", 16)` | `255`; bad input → `NumberFormatException` |
| `Boolean.parseBoolean("YES")` | `false` — only `"true"` (any case) is true |

**`BigInteger`** / **`BigDecimal`** (§7.7): immutable, arbitrary precision.

| Rule | Example |
|---|---|
| Build from a `String` (or `BigDecimal.valueOf(double)`) | `new BigDecimal("0.1").add(new BigDecimal("0.2"))` = `0.3`; `new BigDecimal(0.1)` = `0.1000000000000000055511…` |
| `equals` checks value **and scale**; `compareTo` checks value only | `2.0` vs `2.00`: `equals` false, `compareTo` 0 — so `HashSet<BigDecimal>` can hold both |
| Non-terminating division needs a scale or `MathContext` | `ONE.divide(valueOf(3))` → `ArithmeticException`; `divide(valueOf(3), 4, HALF_UP)` = `0.3333` |
| Rounding modes | `2.345` → `HALF_UP` `2.35`, `HALF_EVEN` (banker's) `2.34` |
| `BigInteger` | `BigInteger.TWO.pow(100)` has 31 digits |

**`java.time`** (§7.8–§7.11) — immutable, thread-safe; months are 1–12:

| Class | Represents | Example |
|---|---|---|
| `LocalDate` / `LocalTime` / `LocalDateTime` | wall-calendar date/time, **no zone** | birthdays, opening hours |
| `ZonedDateTime` | date-time in a region (`ZoneId.of("Europe/Paris")`), DST-aware | meetings |
| `OffsetDateTime` | date-time with a fixed offset (`+02:00`) | API timestamps |
| `Instant` | a point on the UTC time-line | logs, DB timestamps |
| `Duration` | seconds + nanos (machine time) | `Duration.ofMinutes(90)` → `PT1H30M` |
| `Period` | years, months, days (calendar) | 2024-01-15 → 2025-03-20 = `P1Y2M5D` |
| `DateTimeFormatter` | format/parse, thread-safe | `ofPattern("yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm")` |

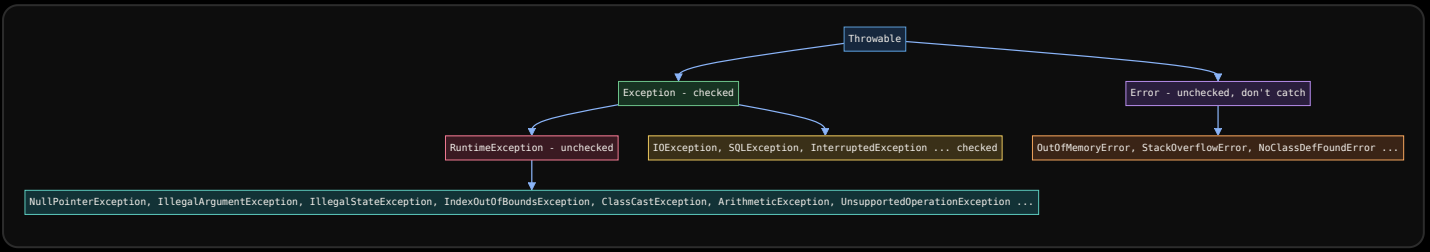
Edge cases (all checked): `LocalDate.of(2024, 1, 31).plusMonths(1)` → `2024-02-29` (clamped); in `America/New_York`, 2025-03-09 01:30 plus 1 hour → 03:30, and that day lasts 23 hours; `yyyy` vs `YYYY` for 2025-12-29 → `2025` vs `2026` (week-based year — a classic bug); `MM` month vs `mm` minute; `HH` 0–23 vs `hh` 1–12; `LocalDate.of(2025, 2, 29)` → `DateTimeException`. Legacy `Date` / `Calendar` / `SimpleDateFormat` are mutable and not thread-safe — convert at the edges.

**Random numbers** (§7.12): `new Random(42)` is reproducible (same seed → same sequence); `ThreadLocalRandom.current()` for concurrent code; `SecureRandom` for tokens and passwords; `RandomGenerator.of("L64X128MixRandom")` (17) for choosing an algorithm; `random.nextInt(lo, hi)` (17) excludes `hi`.

---

## 20.7 Exceptions

**The hierarchy** (§8.2):




| Kind | Which classes | Compiler rule | Meaning |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Checked** | `Exception` and subclasses **except** the `RuntimeException` branch | must be caught or declared with `throws` (§8.3) | a recoverable problem outside the program's control (file, network, DB) |
| **Unchecked** | `RuntimeException` and subclasses | no rule | a programming error (bad argument, bad state, `null`) |
| **Error** | `Error` and subclasses (also unchecked) | no rule | the JVM or environment is in trouble — let it propagate |

| Common exception | Thrown when | Kind |
|---|---|---|
| `NullPointerException` | dereferencing `null` (helpful messages name the `null` part: Java 14, on by default since 15) | unchecked |
| `IllegalArgumentException` / `NumberFormatException` | bad argument / unparsable number | unchecked |
| `IllegalStateException` | object not in the right state (stream reused, `toMap` duplicate key) | unchecked |
| `ArrayIndexOutOfBoundsException`, `StringIndexOutOfBoundsException` | bad index | unchecked |
| `ClassCastException`, `ArithmeticException` | bad cast / integer `/ 0`, overflow in `*Exact` | unchecked |
| `UnsupportedOperationException` | mutating an unmodifiable collection | unchecked |
| `ConcurrentModificationException` | structural change during iteration | unchecked |
| `IOException`, `FileNotFoundException`, `NoSuchFileException` | I/O failure | **checked** |
| `InterruptedException` | a blocked thread was interrupted | **checked** |
| `SQLException` | JDBC failure | **checked** |
| `UncheckedIOException` | an `IOException` wrapped for lambdas/streams | unchecked |

**Syntax rules** (§8.4–§8.6):

| Construct | Rule |
|---|---|
| `try { } catch (A e) { } finally { }` | `catch` or `finally` (or both) required; `finally` runs on normal exit, exception, `return`, `break` |
| Catch order | subclasses before superclasses, else "exception has already been caught" compile error |
| Multi-catch `catch (A \| B e)` | `A` and `B` must not be subtype-related; `e` is effectively final |
| `return` in `finally` | overrides the `try`'s return **and swallows exceptions** — never do it (`try { return 1; } finally { return 2; }` returns `2`) |
| try-with-resources `try (var r = open())` | any `AutoCloseable`; closed automatically in **reverse** order; a close failure is added as **suppressed** to the body's exception (`getSuppressed()`) |
| `finally` doesn't run | only if the JVM exits (`System.exit`, crash) or the thread never leaves `try` |
| Rethrow | `catch (Exception e) { throw e; }` — precise rethrow keeps the narrower checked types |
| Chaining | `throw new ServiceException("load failed", e)` — keep the cause (§8.8) |

```
try (Res a = new Res("A", log); Res b = new Res("B", log)) {
    throw new RuntimeException("body failed");
}   // log: open A, open B, body, close B, close A — both close() failures become suppressed
```

**Custom exceptions** (§8.7): extend `Exception` (checked) or `RuntimeException` (unchecked); provide `(String message)` and `(String message, Throwable cause)` constructors; add fields for context.

**Best practices** (§8.10): throw early (validate arguments with `Objects.requireNonNull`, `IllegalArgumentException`), catch late (where you can really handle it); never swallow (`catch (Exception e) {}`); don't use exceptions for control flow; catch the most specific type; translate low-level exceptions at layer boundaries and keep the cause; log **or** rethrow, not both; clean up with try-with-resources. Reading traces: the first line is the type and message, then frames newest-first; read `Caused by:` sections bottom-up to find the root (§8.9).

---

## 20.8 Generics and PECS

**Syntax** (§9.1–§9.5):

| Form | Example |
|---|---|
| Generic class / record | `class Box<T> { T value; }`, `record Pair<A, B>(A first, B second) {}` |
| Generic interface | `interface Repository<T, ID> { Optional<T> findById(ID id); }` |
| Generic method | `static <T> List<T> repeat(T x, int n)` — type parameter before the return type |
| Explicit type argument | `Collections.<String>emptyList()` (rarely needed — inference) |
| Diamond | `Map<String, List<Integer>> m = new HashMap<>();` |
| Bounded type | `<T extends Number>`, several bounds: `<T extends Number & Comparable<T>>` (class first) |
| Recursive bound | `<T extends Comparable<? super T>> T max(List<? extends T> xs)` |
| Wildcards | `List<?>`, `List<? extends Number>`, `List<? super Integer>` |

Naming convention: `T` type, `E` element, `K` / `V` key/value, `R` result, `ID` identifier.

**Invariance and PECS** (§9.6): `List<Integer>` is **not** a `List<Number>` (arrays are covariant — a `String[]` is an `Object[]` — and fail at run time with `ArrayStoreException`; generics refuse at compile time).

| Wildcard | You can read as | You can add | Use when the parameter… | Example |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| `List<? extends Number>` | `Number` | nothing (except `null`) | **produces** values for you | `double sumAll(List<? extends Number> xs)` |
| `List<? super Integer>` | `Object` | `Integer` | **consumes** values you give it | `void fill(List<? super Integer> sink)` accepts `List<Number>`, `List<Object>` |
| `List<?>` | `Object` | nothing | you only use `Object` methods / size | `printAll(List<?> xs)` |
| `List<T>` | `T` | `T` | you both read and write | `swap(List<T> xs, int i, int j)` |

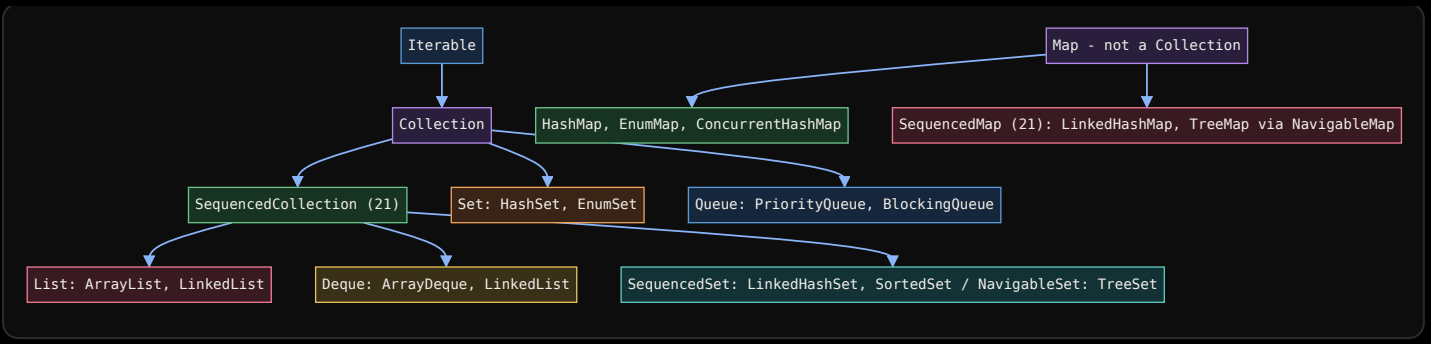
**P**roducer **E**xtends, **C**onsumer **S**uper — e.g. `Collections.copy(List<? super T> dest, List<? extends T> src)`. Don't use wildcards in return types.

**Type erasure** (§9.7, §9.8): generics are checked by the compiler, then erased to their bounds (`Object` if unbounded) with casts inserted. `new ArrayList<String>().getClass() == new ArrayList<Integer>().getClass()` is `true`. So you **can't**: use primitives (`List<int>`), `new T()`, `new T[n]`, `instanceof List<String>`, use `T` in static members, overload `f(List<String>)` with `f(List<Integer>)` (same erasure), or make a generic `Throwable`. Workarounds: `Supplier<T>` factories, `Class<T>` tokens, `List<T>` instead of `T[]`. Raw types (`List raw`) switch checking off — they exist only for pre-Java-5 code. Eliminate unchecked warnings; suppress only on the smallest scope with a comment; mark safe generic varargs methods `@SafeVarargs`.

---

## 20.9 Collections: big-O and which to choose

**The hierarchy** (§10.1):




**Big-O** (§10.12) — `*` amortised, `†` average (worst case O(log n) in a tree-ified bucket):

| Collection | add at end | add/remove at front | get(i) | contains / get(key) | remove element | Order | null ? |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| `ArrayList` | O(1)* | O(n) | O(1) | O(n) | O(n) | index | yes |
| `LinkedList` | O(1) | O(1) | O(n) | O(n) | O(n) | index | yes |
| `ArrayDeque` | O(1)* | O(1)* | — | O(n) | O(n) | head → tail | **no** |
| `PriorityQueue` | O(log n) | `poll` O(log n), `peek` O(1) | — | O(n) | O(n) | heap (iteration unsorted) | no |
| `HashSet` / `HashMap` | O(1)† | — | — | O(1)† | O(1)† | none | one `null` key |
| `LinkedHashSet` / `LinkedHashMap` | O(1)† | — | — | O(1)† | O(1)† | insertion (or access) | one `null` key |
| `TreeSet` / `TreeMap` | O(log n) | — | — | O(log n) | O(log n) | sorted | no `null` keys (natural order) |
| `EnumSet` / `EnumMap` | O(1) | — | — | O(1) | O(1) | enum order | no |
| `CopyOnWriteArrayList` | O(n) | O(n) | O(1) | O(n) | O(n) | index | yes |
| `ConcurrentHashMap` | O(1)† | — | — | O(1)† | O(1)† | none | **no** |

**Which one?** (§10.13) Key → value: `HashMap`; insertion order or LRU: `LinkedHashMap`; sorted or range queries: `TreeMap`. Unique elements: `HashSet` / `LinkedHashSet` / `TreeSet` by the same rule. Indexed or append: `ArrayList` (the default list). Stack or queue: `ArrayDeque` (not `Stack`, not `LinkedList`). "Smallest next": `PriorityQueue`. Enum keys: `EnumMap` / `EnumSet`. Fixed data: `List.of` / `Set.of` / `Map.of`. Shared between threads: `ConcurrentHashMap`, `CopyOnWriteArrayList`, `BlockingQueue`.

**`HashMap` internals** (§10.5): table of buckets, default capacity 16, load factor 0.75 (resize — double — when size > capacity × 0.75); index = `(h ^ (h >>> 16)) & (capacity − 1)`; collisions chain in a list that turns into a red-black tree past 8 entries once the table has ≥ 64 buckets; lookup = hash, then `equals`. Keys must have consistent `equals` / `hashCode` and must not change while in the map.

**Unmodifiable vs views** (§10.10):

| Factory | Changes through it? | Sees later changes to the source? | `null` s |
|---|---|---|---|
| `List.of`, `Set.of`, `Map.of` (9) | no — `UnsupportedOperationException` | — (no source) | **rejected** (NPE); `Set.of("a","a")` → `IllegalArgumentException` |
| `List.copyOf` (10), `stream.toList()` (16) | no | no — a snapshot | `copyOf` rejects; `toList()` **allows** `null` (unlike `Collectors.toUnmodifiableList()`) |
| `Collections.unmodifiableList(src)` | no | **yes** — a read-only view | allowed |
| `Arrays.asList(array)` | `set` yes (writes through to the array); `add` / `remove` no | yes | allowed |

**API you use daily** (§10.2–§10.6, §10.9, §10.11):

| Want | Call | Result in the checks |
|---|---|---|
| Count words | `map.merge(w, 1, Integer::sum)` | `{a=1, b=3, c=1}` in a `TreeMap` |
| Group into lists | `map.computeIfAbsent(k, x -> new ArrayList<>()).add(v)` | |
| Default | `map.getOrDefault(k, -1)` | `-1` |
| Previous value | `map.put("a", 2)` | returns the old value (`null` if none) |
| Nearest keys | `treeMap.floorKey(25)`, `ceilingKey(25)` on {10, 20, 30} | `20`, `30`; `floorKey(5)` = `null` |
| Sub-ranges | `headMap(20)` / `tailMap(20)` | `[10]` / `[20, 30]` (head exclusive, tail inclusive) |
| Stack | `deque.push(x)`, `pop()`, `peek()` | `push` = `addFirst` |
| Queue | `deque.offer(x)`, `poll()`, `peek()` | `offer` = `addLast`; `poll` returns `null` when empty, `remove` throws |
| Min-heap / max-heap | `new PriorityQueue<>()` / `new PriorityQueue<>(Comparator.reverseOrder())` | `poll()` of {5, 1, 4}: `1` / `5` |
| LRU cache | `new LinkedHashMap<>(16, 0.75f, true)` + override `removeEldestEntry` → `size() > cap` | |
| Ends of an ordered collection (21) | `getFirst()`, `getLast()`, `addFirst`, `removeLast`, `reversed()` | `[x, y, z]` → `x`, `z`, `[z, y, x]` |
| Sort with several keys | `list.sort(comparing(String::length).thenComparing(reverseOrder()))` | `[fig, pear, kiwi, apple]` |
| Remove while iterating | `removeIf(pred)` or `iterator.remove()` | for-each + `list.remove` → `ConcurrentModificationException` |
| Utilities | `Collections.sort`, `reverse`, `shuffle`, `frequency`, `max`, `nCopies`, `emptyList` | |

**Ordering** (§10.8): `Comparable<T>.compareTo` = the class's one natural order; `Comparator<T>` = any number of external orders (`comparing`, `thenComparing`, `reversed`, `nullsFirst`). Never compare by subtraction (`a - b` overflows) — use `Integer.compare`. `TreeSet` / `TreeMap` treat `compareTo == 0` as "equal", so keep it consistent with `equals`.

---

## 20.10 Functional interfaces, lambdas and `Optional`

`java.util.function` (§11.2, §11.3) — a *functional interface* has exactly one abstract method:

| Interface | Shape | Method | Typical use |
|---|---|---|---|
| `Supplier<T>` | `() → T` | `get` | factories, lazy defaults, `orElseGet` |
| `Consumer<T>` / `BiConsumer<T,U>` | `T → void` / `(T,U) → void` | `accept` | `forEach`, `Map.forEach` |
| `Predicate<T>` / `BiPredicate<T,U>` | `T → boolean` | `test` | `filter`, `removeIf` |
| `Function<T,R>` / `BiFunction<T,U,R>` | `T → R` / `(T,U) → R` | `apply` | `map`, `computeIfAbsent`, `merge` |
| `UnaryOperator<T>` / `BinaryOperator<T>` | `T → T` / `(T,T) → T` | `apply` | `replaceAll`, `reduce` |
| `IntPredicate`, `IntFunction<R>`, `ToIntFunction<T>`, `IntUnaryOperator`, `IntBinaryOperator`, `IntSupplier`, `ObjIntConsumer<T>` … | primitive versions (also `Long…`, `Double…`) | `test`, `apply`, `applyAsInt`, `getAsInt` … | avoid boxing in hot code |
| `Runnable` / `Callable<V>` | `() → void` / `() → V`, may throw | `run` / `call` | tasks |
| `Comparator<T>` | `(T,T) → int` | `compare` | sorting |

**Lambda syntax**: `() -> 42`, `x -> x * 2`, `(a, b) -> a + b`, `(String s) -> s.length()`, `(var x, var y) -> …`, block form `x -> { …; return r; }`. Captured local variables must be **effectively final** (§11.5); fields can change. `this` in a lambda is the enclosing object (in an anonymous class it's the anonymous object).

**Method references** (§11.4):

| Kind | Syntax | Equivalent lambda |
|---|---|---|
| Static method | `Integer::sum` | `(a, b) -> Integer.sum(a, b)` |
| Bound instance (specific object) | `System.out::println`, `"*"::repeat` | `x -> System.out.println(x)` |
| Unbound instance (first argument is the receiver) | `String::toUpperCase` | `s -> s.toUpperCase()` |
| Constructor | `ArrayList::new`, `int[]::new` | `() -> new ArrayList<>()` |

**Composition** (§11.6): `f.andThen(g)` runs `f` then `g`; `f.compose(g)` runs `g` then `f` (with `plus1`, `times2` on 3: `8` vs `7`); `Predicate.and/or/negate`, `Predicate.not(String::isBlank)` (11); `Function.identity()`; `Comparator.comparing(...).thenComparing(...)`.

**`Optional<T>`** (§11.7) — a return type for "maybe no result":

| Do | Don't |
|---|---|
| `opt.map(f).filter(p).orElse(default)` | `opt.get()` without checking (→ `NoSuchElementException`) |
| `orElseGet(() -> expensive())` for costly defaults | `orElse(expensive())` — the argument is **always** evaluated |
| `orElseThrow()` (10) when absence is a bug | `Optional` fields, parameters, collection elements |
| `ifPresentOrElse`, `or`, `stream()` (9) | returning `null` from a method that returns `Optional` |
| return an empty collection for "no results" | `Optional<List<…>>` |
| `Optional.ofNullable(x)` for maybe-null values | `Optional.of(null)` (→ `NullPointerException`) |
| `OptionalInt` / `OptionalDouble` for primitives | `Optional<Integer>` in hot numeric code |

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## 20.11 Streams and collectors

A **stream** is a one-shot, lazy pipeline over a source: **source → zero or more intermediate operations → one terminal operation** (§12.1, §12.2). Nothing runs until the terminal operation; elements flow one at a time, and short-circuiting operations stop early:

```
Stream.of(1, 2, 3, 4).peek(x -> trace.add("saw " + x)).filter(x -> x > 1).findFirst();
// result 2, trace [saw 1, saw 2] — elements 3 and 4 are never touched
```

| Stage | Operations |
|---|---|
| Sources | `coll.stream()`, `Stream.of(…)`, `Arrays.stream(a)`, `IntStream.range(0, n)` / `rangeClosed`, `Stream.iterate(seed, hasNext, next)` (9), `Stream.generate(s)`, `Files.lines(p)`, `str.chars()`, `map.entrySet().stream()` |
| Intermediate, stateless | `filter`, `map`, `mapToInt/Long/Double`, `mapToObj`, `boxed`, `flatMap`, `mapMulti` (16), `peek` (debugging only) |
| Intermediate, stateful | `distinct`, `sorted`, `limit`, `skip`, `takeWhile` / `dropWhile` (9), `gather(…)` (24) |
| Terminal | `forEach`, `collect`, `toList()` (16), `toArray`, `reduce`, `count`, `min` / `max`, `sum` / `average` (primitive streams), `findFirst` / `findAny`, `anyMatch` / `allMatch` / `noneMatch` |

**Terminal facts** (§12.4): on an empty stream `anyMatch` → `false`, `allMatch` and `noneMatch` → `true`; `reduce(identity, op)` returns `T`, `reduce(op)` returns `Optional<T>`; `IntStream.average()` returns `OptionalDouble`; `Stream.toList()` is unmodifiable but accepts `null` elements; reusing a consumed stream → `IllegalStateException`.

**Collectors** (§12.5) — the examples use five employees (eng: Ann 120, Bob 100; ops: Cid 90, Dee 95; hr: Eve 80):

| Collector | Result in the checks | Watch out |
|---|---|---|
| `groupingBy(Emp::dept, TreeMap::new, counting())` | `{eng=2, hr=1, ops=2}` | default map is a `HashMap` (no order) |
| `partitioningBy(e -> e.salary() >= 100, mapping(Emp::name, toList()))` | `{false=[Cid, Dee, Eve], true=[Ann, Bob]}` | always has both keys, even for an empty stream |
| `toMap(Emp::dept, Emp::name)` | `IllegalStateException` | duplicate keys throw; `null` values → NPE |
| `toMap(Emp::dept, Emp::salary, Math::max, TreeMap::new)` | `{eng=120, hr=80, ops=95}` | merge function resolves duplicates |
| `joining(", ", "[", "]")` | `[Ann, Bob, Cid, Dee, Eve]` | elements must be `CharSequence` |
| `counting()`, `summingInt`, `averagingDouble`, `minBy`, `maxBy`, `summarizingInt` | numbers, `Optional`, `IntSummaryStatistics` | usually as downstream collectors |
| `mapping`, `filtering` (9), `flatMapping` (9), `collectingAndThen`, `teeing` (12) | adapted results | |
| `toList()`, `toSet()`, `toUnmodifiableList()` (10), `toCollection(TreeSet::new)` | collections | `Collectors.toList()` mutability is unspecified |

**Primitive streams** (§12.6): `IntStream`, `LongStream`, `DoubleStream` have `sum`, `average`, `summaryStatistics`, `range`; convert with `mapToInt` / `boxed` / `mapToObj`. `IntStream.rangeClosed(1, 5).reduce(1, (a, b) -> a * b)` = `120`.

**Gatherers** (Java 24, §12.9): `stream.gather(g)` is a custom intermediate operation. Built-ins in `Gatherers`: `windowFixed(2)` on 1..5 → `[[1, 2], [3, 4], [5]]`; `windowSliding(n)`; `scan(() -> 0, Integer::sum)` on 1, 2, 3 → `[1, 3, 6]`; `fold`; `mapConcurrent(n, f)` (runs `f` on virtual threads, keeps order).

**Rules and mistakes** (§12.7, §12.8, §12.10, §12.11): lambdas in a pipeline should be stateless and must not modify the source; don't use `peek` / `forEach` to fill an outside list — collect instead; `sorted` / `distinct` on infinite streams never finish; close streams from `Files.lines` / `list` / `walk`. Parallel streams pay off only for large, CPU-bound, easily split, stateless work (they use the common `ForkJoinPool`); never for I/O. Loops remain better for early exits with complex state, checked exceptions and index arithmetic.

---

## 20.12 I/O and NIO.2

**Which API?** (§13.1):

| Need | Use | Since |
|---|---|---|
| Name a file or directory | `Path.of("dir", "a.txt")` (was `Paths.get`) | 7 (`Path.of` 11) |
| Small text file in one call | `Files.readString(p)`, `Files.writeString(p, s)` | 11 |
| Lines of a small file | `Files.readAllLines(p)`, `Files.write(p, lines)` | 7 |
| Huge text file | `try (Stream<String> s = Files.lines(p))` or `Files.newBufferedReader(p)` | 8 / 7 |
| Raw bytes from anywhere | `InputStream` / `OutputStream` (+ `transferTo`, `readAllBytes`) | 1.0 (9) |
| Text from anywhere | `Reader` / `Writer` with an explicit charset | 1.1 |
| Big files, random access, memory mapping | `FileChannel` + `ByteBuffer` | 1.4 |
| Legacy code that wants `File` | `path.toFile()`, `file.toPath()` | 7 |

**`Path`** (§13.2) never touches the disk: `Path.of("/a/b/../c/./d.txt").normalize()` → `/a/c/d.txt`; `Path.of("/a/b").relativize(Path.of("/a/c/d"))` → `../c/d`; `Path.of("/a").resolve("b.txt")` → `/a/b.txt`; `getFileName`, `getParent`, `getRoot`, `toAbsolutePath`, `startsWith`.

**`Files`** (§13.3, §13.4): `exists`, `isDirectory`, `createDirectories` (no error if present), `createFile` (fails if the file exists — `FileAlreadyExistsException`), `createTempFile` / `createTempDirectory`, `copy` / `move` (add `REPLACE_EXISTING`, `ATOMIC_MOVE`), `delete` (throws if missing or a non-empty directory) / `deleteIfExists`, `size`, `mismatch` (12), `list` / `walk` / `find` (lazy `Stream<Path>` — **close them**). `Files.size` counts **bytes**: `"ünï\n"` is 6 bytes in UTF-8.

**Streams and decorators** (§13.5, §13.6): byte streams (`InputStream` / `OutputStream`) vs character streams (`Reader` / `Writer`); bridge with `InputStreamReader` / `OutputStreamWriter` and a charset; wrap in `BufferedReader` / `BufferedWriter` / `BufferedInputStream` (8 KB buffer by default) — unbuffered byte-at-a-time I/O is very slow, and a writer you forget to `flush` / `close` loses data. Always use try-with-resources.

**Charsets** (§13.7): the default charset is **UTF-8** since Java 18 (`Charset.defaultCharset()`); still pass `StandardCharsets.UTF_8` explicitly for files other systems produce. Mojibake = bytes decoded with the wrong charset.

**Binary data** (§13.9): `DataInputStream` / `DataOutputStream` for primitives; `FileChannel`, `ByteBuffer` (`flip` before reading what you wrote), memory-mapped files; `WatchService` for directory change events.

**Serialization** (§13.10): `implements Serializable`, `transient` fields are skipped, declare `serialVersionUID`. Deserialising untrusted data is a **security risk** (gadget chains) — prefer JSON or protobuf; if you must, use deserialization filters (`ObjectInputFilter`, 9; context-specific filters, 17).

**Also** (§13.8, §13.11–§13.13): `Properties` for `key=value` config (`load`, `getProperty(k, default)`); JSON needs a library (Jackson, Gson) — the JDK has none; `System.in` / `out` / `err`, `Console`, `Scanner`, `IO` (25).

---

## 20.13 Concurrency

**Threads** (§14.1–§14.4):

```
Thread t = Thread.ofPlatform().name("worker").start(task);      // or new Thread(task).start()
Thread v = Thread.ofVirtual().start(task);                      // Java 21
t.join();                                                       // wait for it to finish
```

Call `start()`, not `run()` (which runs on the *current* thread). States: `NEW` → `RUNNABLE` → (`BLOCKED` on a monitor · `WAITING` on `wait`/`join`/`park` · `TIMED_WAITING` on `sleep`/timeouts) → `TERMINATED`. Interruption is cooperative: `t.interrupt()` sets a flag; blocking methods throw `InterruptedException` — rethrow it or restore the flag with `Thread.currentThread().interrupt()`, never swallow it. There is no safe way to kill a thread: `Thread.stop()` threw `UnsupportedOperationException` from Java 20 and was removed in JDK 26. The JVM exits when only daemon threads remain.

**The primitives** (§14.5–§14.13):

| Tool | Gives you | Use for | Remember |
|---|---|---|---|
| `synchronized` (method or block) | mutual exclusion **and** visibility; reentrant | protecting shared mutable state, multi-variable invariants | instance method locks `this`, static method locks the `Class` object; released automatically |
| `volatile` field | visibility and ordering only | a stop flag, safely publishing a reference | `count++` on a volatile is **still a race** |
| `AtomicInteger`, `AtomicLong`, `AtomicReference` | lock-free single-variable updates via CAS | counters, sequence numbers | `compareAndSet(expected, new)` → `true` only if the value matched; `LongAdder` for very hot counters |
| `ReentrantLock` | `tryLock`, timeouts, interruptible, fair mode, several `Condition`s | when `synchronized` isn't flexible enough | **`unlock()` `in` `finally`** |
| `ReadWriteLock` / `StampedLock` | many readers or one writer / optimistic reads | read-mostly data | `StampedLock` is not reentrant |
| `wait` / `notifyAll` | guarded blocks | legacy code — prefer `java.util.concurrent` | call in a `while` loop, holding the lock |
| `ConcurrentHashMap` | thread-safe map with atomic `merge`, `compute`, `computeIfAbsent`, `putIfAbsent` | shared caches, counters | no `null` keys/values; iterators weakly consistent |
| `CopyOnWriteArrayList` | snapshot iteration, never throws CME | listeners, read-mostly lists | every write copies the array |
| `BlockingQueue` (`ArrayBlockingQueue`, `LinkedBlockingQueue`) | `put` waits when full, `take` waits when empty | producer–consumer | prefer bounded queues |
| `CountDownLatch(n)` | wait until n `countDown()` calls | start/finish gates | one-shot |
| `CyclicBarrier(n)` | n threads wait for each other, repeatedly | phased algorithms | reusable |
| `Semaphore(k)` | at most k holders at a time | limit concurrent DB/API calls (also with virtual threads) | `release` in `finally` |
| `ThreadLocal` / `ScopedValue` (25) | per-thread value / immutable per-call context | request context | remove `ThreadLocal`s on pooled threads |

**Executors** (§14.11): `try (ExecutorService pool = Executors.newFixedThreadPool(n)) { Future<T> f = pool.submit(callable); }` — `ExecutorService` is `AutoCloseable` since Java 19, and `close()` waits for submitted tasks. Factories: `newFixedThreadPool(n)` (unbounded queue!), `newCachedThreadPool()` (unbounded threads!), `newSingleThreadExecutor()`, `newScheduledThreadPool(n)`, `newWorkStealingPool()`, `newVirtualThreadPerTaskExecutor()` (21). For full control use `new ThreadPoolExecutor(core, max, keepAlive, unit, boundedQueue, factory, rejectionPolicy)`. Size CPU-bound pools ≈ number of cores.

**`CompletableFuture`** (§15.1, §15.2):

| Method | Does | Checked result |
|---|---|---|
| `supplyAsync(supplier[, executor])` / `runAsync` | start async work (default: common `ForkJoinPool`) | |
| `thenApply(fn)` | transform (like `map`) | |
| `thenCompose(fn)` | chain another async step (like `flatMap`) | `5` → `6` |
| `thenCombine(other, fn)` | combine two independent results | price 20 × qty 3 = `60` |
| `allOf(…)` / `anyOf(…)` | wait for all / the first | |
| `exceptionally(fn)` | recover on failure | `-1` |
| `handle((v, ex) -> …)` / `whenComplete` | always runs; can change result / can't | |
| `orTimeout(d, unit)` / `completeOnTimeout(v, d, unit)` (9) | time limits | |
| `join()` / `get()` | block for the result | `join` wraps failures in `CompletionException` (unchecked); `get` in `ExecutionException` (checked) |

**Virtual threads** (Java 21, §15.4, §15.5): cheap threads scheduled by the JVM onto a few carrier (platform) threads; blocking I/O unmounts them. Use one per task (`newVirtualThreadPerTaskExecutor()`) for **I/O-bound**, high-concurrency work; they don't speed up CPU-bound work. Don't pool them; cap scarce resources with a `Semaphore`; avoid big `ThreadLocal` caches. They are always daemon threads. Since **Java 24** (JEP 491) blocking inside `synchronized` no longer pins the carrier; native calls that call back into blocking Java code, and class initialisation, still do.

**Also modern** (§15.3, §15.6, §15.7): Fork/Join (`RecursiveTask`, work stealing, used by parallel streams); **scoped values** are final in Java 25 (`ScopedValue.where(USER, "alice").call(() -> USER.get())` → `"alice"`, and unbound again afterwards); **structured concurrency** (`StructuredTaskScope.open()` plus a `Joiner` policy) is still **preview** in 25 (JEP 505) and kept changing in 26 (JEP 525) and 27 (JEP 533: built-in joiners make `join()` throw `ExecutionException`, `awaitAll()` removed) — don't write production code against it yet.

**Java Memory Model** (§15.8): without a *happens-before* edge another thread may never see your write. Edges: program order in one thread; unlock → later lock of the same monitor; volatile write → later read of that field; `Thread.start()` → actions in the thread; actions in a thread → a successful `join()`; `java.util.concurrent` hand-offs (queue put → take, `countDown` → `await`, task submit → run, task → `Future.get`); transitivity. Safe publication: `final` fields, volatile, locks, concurrent collections, static initialisers.

**Liveness** (§15.9): **deadlock** (threads wait for each other's locks forever — fix with one global lock order, `tryLock` with timeout, fewer locks; diagnose with `jstack` / `jcmd Thread.print`), **livelock** (threads keep reacting to each other without progress — add randomised back-off), **starvation** (a thread never gets CPU or a lock — fair locks, bounded work).

**Choosing a model** (§15.10): blocking I/O at scale → virtual threads; fan-out/fan-in with composition → `CompletableFuture` (structured concurrency once final); CPU-heavy data work → parallel streams / Fork/Join / fixed pool of ≈ cores; periodic jobs → `ScheduledExecutorService`; shared counters/caches → atomics, `LongAdder`, `ConcurrentHashMap`. For design-level concurrency case studies see the LLD handbook.

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## 20.14 The JVM: memory, GC, flags and tools

**How code runs** (§1.6, §1.7, §16.1, §16.2, §16.8): `javac` → bytecode in `.class` files → class loaders load classes lazily (bootstrap → platform → application, **parent-first delegation**) → verify, prepare, resolve, initialise (static initialisers run once) → the interpreter runs bytecode; hot methods are compiled by the tiered JIT (**C1** fast, then **C2** heavily optimising: inlining, devirtualisation, escape

analysis, loop optimisations, deoptimisation when assumptions break). Hence "warm-up". Class loaders in the checks: `String.class.getClassLoader()` is `null` (bootstrap), `java.sql` classes use the `platform` loader, your classes the `app` loader.

**Memory areas** (§16.3, §1.8):

| Area | Per thread? | Holds | Size flag | When it runs out |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Heap (young: eden + survivors; old) | shared | all objects and arrays | `-Xms`, `-Xmx`, `-XX:MaxRAMPercentage` | `OutOfMemoryError: Java heap space` |
| Java stack | per thread | frames: locals, operand stack | `-Xss` | `StackOverflowError` |
| Metaspace (native memory; replaced PermGen in 8) | shared | class metadata | `-XX:MaxMetaspaceSize` (unlimited by default) | `OutOfMemoryError: Metaspace` |
| Code cache | shared | JIT-compiled code | `-XX:ReservedCodeCacheSize` | JIT stops compiling (slow, not a crash) |
| Direct / native memory | shared | direct `ByteBuffer`s, thread stacks, GC structures | `-XX:MaxDirectMemorySize` | `OutOfMemoryError: Direct buffer memory` / `unable to create native thread` |

Object size basics (§16.4): 12-byte header (8 with `-XX:+UseCompactObjectHeaders`, Java 25; the default from JDK 27), 4-byte compressed references, padded to 8 bytes — `new Object()` is 16 bytes; `record Point(int x, int y)` 24.

**Garbage collectors** (§16.5–§16.7) — an object is garbage when it isn't reachable from GC roots (thread stacks, static fields, JNI handles):

| Collector | Flag | Pauses | Choose it for |
|---|---|---|---|
| **G1** (default since 9 on machines with ≥ 2 CPUs and ≥ 1792 MB; in all environments from JDK 27, JEP 523) | `-XX:+UseG1GC` | goal `-XX:MaxGCPauseMillis` (200 ms default); typically a few–tens of ms | most services — the default for a reason |
| Parallel | `-XX:+UseParallelGC` | longer, grows with live data | batch jobs: maximum throughput |
| Serial | `-XX:+UseSerialGC` | stop-the-world, single thread | tiny heaps, 1 CPU, CLI tools (before JDK 27 the JVM picked it on machines with < 2 CPUs or < 1792 MB) |
| **ZGC** (generational; generational-only since 24) | `-XX:+UseZGC` | typically < 1 ms, independent of heap size | latency-sensitive services, huge heaps |
| Shenandoah (generational mode product in 25) | `-XX:+UseShenandoahGC` | sub-ms to a few ms | low latency; in most OpenJDK builds, not Oracle's |
| Epsilon | `-XX:+UnlockExperimentalVMOptions -XX:+UseEpsilonGC` | none — never collects | benchmarks, ultra-short jobs |

**Key flags** (§16.7):

| Flag | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `-Xms512m -Xmx2g` | initial / maximum heap (set them equal for servers to avoid resizing) |
| `-XX:MaxRAMPercentage=75` | heap as % of container memory (default 25) |
| `-Xss1m` | thread stack size (default platform-dependent: about 1 MB on 64-bit Linux, 2 MB on macOS/AArch64) |
| `-Xlog:gc*` (or `-Xlog:gc:file=gc.log`) | unified GC logging (9+) |
| `-XX:+HeapDumpOnOutOfMemoryError -XX:HeapDumpPath=/dumps` | heap dump on `OutOfMemoryError` |
| `-XX:+PrintFlagsFinal` | print every flag's final value |
| `-XX:StartFlightRecording=duration=60s,filename=app.jfr` | record with JDK Flight Recorder at start-up |
| `-XX:TieredStopAtLevel=1` | C1 only: faster start-up, lower peak speed |
| `-ea` | enable `assert` statements |
| `--enable-preview` | allow preview features (needs `--release N` at compile time) |
| `-XX:+UseCompactObjectHeaders` | 8-byte object headers (25, opt-in; on by default from JDK 27, JEP 534) |

**Diagnostic tools** (§16.10, §16.11):

| Tool | Use |
|---|---|
| `jps -l` | list running JVMs and PIDs |
| `jcmd <pid> help` | the Swiss-army knife: `VM.flags`, `GC.heap_info`, `GC.class_histogram`, `Thread.print`, `GC.heap_dump file.hprof`, `JFR.start` / `JFR.dump`, `VM.native_memory` |
| `jstat -gcutil <pid> 1000` | heap occupancy and GC counts every second |
| `jstack <pid>` | thread dump — look for `BLOCKED` and "Found one Java-level deadlock" |
| JFR + `jfr view hot-methods app.jfr` / JDK Mission Control | low-overhead production profiling |
| VisualVM, Eclipse MAT, async-profiler | GUI monitoring, heap-dump analysis (dominator tree), flame graphs |
| JMH | micro-benchmarks that avoid warm-up and dead-code traps (§16.9) |
| `jdeps`, `jlink` | module dependencies / build a trimmed runtime (§16.12) |

Symptom → first tool: high CPU → JFR hot methods; latency spikes → GC log pauses; hangs → two or three thread dumps; memory growth → `jstat` old-gen trend + class histogram twice, then a heap dump; RSS far above heap → native memory tracking. Classic leaks: unbounded static caches, unregistered listeners, `ThreadLocal`s on pooled threads, mutated `HashMap` keys, class-loader leaks.

**Modules (JPMS)** (§16.12): `module-info.java` with `requires`, `exports`, `opens` (for reflection), `uses`/`provides` (services); the class path is the *unnamed module*; `import module java.base;` (25) imports every exported package of a module.

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## 20.15 Modern Java by version: 17 to 25

Final features only — the version that **finalised** each one (§17.2; JEP numbers in parentheses). The book's baseline before 17: `var` (10), `HttpClient` and `java Hello.java` (11), switch expressions and helpful NPE messages (14; the messages on by default since 15), text blocks (15), records, `instanceof` patterns and `Stream.toList()` (16).

| Release | Final features (JEP numbers and the JVM/tool changes: §17.2) |
|---|---|
| **17 LTS** (Sep 2021) | sealed classes, enhanced pseudo-random generators, always-strict floating point, context-specific deserialization filters; strong encapsulation of JDK internals |
| **18** (Mar 2022) | UTF-8 by default, `@snippet` in Javadoc, `jwebserver`; finalization deprecated for removal |
| **19, 20** | previews and incubators only (Linux/RISC-V port in 19) |
| **21 LTS** (Sep 2023) | record patterns, pattern matching for `switch`, **virtual threads**, sequenced collections, KEM API; generational ZGC |
| **22** (Mar 2024) | unnamed variables and patterns `_`, Foreign Function & Memory API, multi-file source launch |
| **23** (Sep 2024) | Markdown doc comments `///`; ZGC generational by default; `Unsafe` memory access deprecated for removal |
| **24** (Mar 2025) | **stream gatherers**, Class-File API, ML-KEM/ML-DSA; no `synchronized` pinning, AOT class loading, non-generational ZGC removed, Security Manager disabled |
| **25 LTS** (Sep 2025) | compact source files and instance `main`, module imports, flexible constructor bodies, **scoped values**, KDF API; compact object headers (opt-in), generational Shenandoah, AOT ergonomics and method profiling |

**Still not final in Java 25** (§17.11): structured concurrency (fifth preview, 505; sixth in 26, seventh in 27), primitive types in patterns (third preview, 507), stable values (preview, 502; renamed *lazy constants* in 26), PEM encodings (preview, 470), Vector API (tenth incubator, 508), JFR CPU-time profiling (experimental, 509). **Withdrawn**: string templates (previewed in 21 and 22, removed in 23). Try a preview with `javac --release 25 --enable-preview` and `java --enable-preview`. After 25 (§17.11): JDK 26 (Mar 2026) finalised HTTP/3 in `HttpClient` (517) and removed the Applet API (504) and `Thread.stop`; JDK 27 (Sep 2026) made G1 the default everywhere (523) and compact object headers the default (534). LTS releases: 8, 11, 17, 21, 25 (every two years); the next is expected to be 29 in September 2027 (§1.12).

Upgrading 17 → 25 (§17.12): raise the JDK first and `--release` second; upgrade build plugins and bytecode libraries (Lombok, Mockito, Byte Buddy, Spring); run `jdeps --jdk-internals` and `jdeprscan`; read the start-up warnings (agents, JNI, `Unsafe`); drop removed flags such as `-XX:-ZGenerational`.

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## 20.16 Testing, build and tooling commands

**JDK tools** (§1.4–§1.11, §18.12, §18.13):

| Command | Does |
|---|---|
| `java -version`, `javac -version` | check the installed JDK |
| `javac --release 25 -d out $(find src -name '*.java')` | compile for a target Java version |
| `java -cp out:lib/* com.example.Main` | run with a class path (`;` on Windows) |
| `jar --create --file app.jar --main-class com.example.Main -C out .` | build an executable JAR; run with `java -jar app.jar` |
| `javadoc -d docs …`, `javap -c`, `jshell` | docs, bytecode, REPL |
| `jlink`, `jpackage` | custom runtime image / native installer |
| `bash tools_run_java.sh java` | this book's runner: compiles each chapter's `code/` with `--release 25` and runs every `main` |

**Maven** (§18.2; this book: Maven 3.9.14, Gradle 9.4.1) — `pom.xml`; coordinates `groupId:artifactId:version`; scopes `compile`, `test`, `provided`, `runtime`; "nearest wins" for version conflicts (pin with `dependencyManagement`); pin every plugin version too. Lifecycle: `validate → compile → test-compile → test → package → verify → install → deploy` — running a phase runs every phase before it.

| Command | Does |
|---|---|
| `mvn clean verify` | full build with all checks (what CI runs) |
| `mvn test`, `mvn -Dtest=CartTest test` | run all / one test class (`CartTest#method` for one method) |
| `mvn package -DskipTests` | build the JAR without running tests |
| `mvn dependency:tree` | print the resolved dependency tree |
| `./mvnw …` | the Maven Wrapper: pinned Maven version, committed to the repo |

**Gradle** (§18.3) — `build.gradle(.kts)`; configurations `implementation`, `testImplementation`, `runtimeOnly`; incremental and cached tasks.

| Command | Does |
|---|---|
| `./gradlew build` | compile, test, assemble |
| `./gradlew test --tests 'ch18.shop.CartTest'` | run matching tests |
| `./gradlew run` | run the `application` plugin's main class |
| `./gradlew dependencies --configuration testRuntimeClasspath`, `./gradlew tasks` | inspect |

**JUnit Jupiter** (§18.4, §18.5, §18.8) — the same API in JUnit 5 and JUnit 6 (6.0, 2025: Java 17 baseline, one version number for Platform/Jupiter/Vintage, JSpecify annotations, Vintage deprecated); this book ran JUnit 6.1.3:

| Annotation | Meaning |
|---|---|
| `@Test` | a test method (package-private is fine) |
| `@BeforeEach` / `@AfterEach` | run around every test (a new test-class instance per test by default) |
| `@BeforeAll` / `@AfterAll` | once per class (`static`) |
| `@DisplayName`, `@Disabled`, `@Tag`, `@Timeout`, `@Nested` | naming, skipping, filtering, time limit, grouping |
| `@ParameterizedTest` + `@ValueSource`, `@CsvSource`, `@MethodSource`, `@EnumSource`, `@NullAndEmptySource` | one test, many inputs |
| `@TempDir Path dir` | fresh temporary directory |
| `@ExtendWith(MockitoExtension.class)` | plug in an extension |

Assertions: `assertEquals(expected, actual)` (expected first), `assertTrue`, `assertNull`, `assertThrows(X.class, () -> …)` (returns the exception), `assertAll(…)` (report every failure), `assertIterableEquals`, `assertTimeout`. Console launcher: `java -jar junit-platform-console-standalone-<version>.jar execute --class-path out:libs --scan-class-path`.

**Mockito** (§18.6): `mock(Repo.class)` or `@Mock`; stub with `when(repo.find("a")).thenReturn(Optional.of(x))` / `thenThrow`; `verify(repo).save(any())`, `verify(repo, never()).delete(…)`, `times(2)`; `ArgumentCaptor`; `@InjectMocks`; stub only what the test needs (strict stubs flag the rest). Fakes beat mocks for simple collaborators. Mockito 5 (this book: 5.24.0) mocks `final` classes through an agent — on JDK 21+ add `-javaagent:mockito-core.jar` to the test JVM (Surefire `argLine`, Gradle `jvmArgs`) instead of letting it self-attach.

**AssertJ** (§18.7): `assertThat(list).hasSize(3).containsExactly("a", "b", "c")`; `assertThat(s).startsWith("J").contains("av")`; `assertThatThrownBy(() -> …).isInstanceOf(IllegalArgumentException.class).hasMessageContaining("negative")`; `extracting(Order::id)`; `usingRecursiveComparison()`.

**Test design** (§18.9): Arrange–Act–Assert; one behaviour per test; name tests after behaviour; FIRST (fast, independent, repeatable, self-validating, timely); inject clocks and random seeds; test pyramid (many unit, some integration — Testcontainers — few end-to-end). Testcontainers starts throwaway real services (such as a database) in Docker containers for tests.

**Logging** (§18.10): code against SLF4J (`private static final Logger log = LoggerFactory.getLogger(Foo.class); log.info("order {} placed", id);` — placeholders, not concatenation), with Logback or Log4j 2 as the backend; levels `TRACE < DEBUG < INFO < WARN < ERROR`; `java.util.logging` is built in (`FINE`, `INFO`, `WARNING`, `SEVERE`). Pass the exception as the last argument to keep the stack trace.

**JDBC** (§18.11): `try (Connection c = dataSource.getConnection(); PreparedStatement ps = c.prepareStatement("SELECT … WHERE id = ?")) { ps.setLong(1, id); try (ResultSet rs = ps.executeQuery()) { while (rs.next()) … } }` — always `PreparedStatement` (prevents SQL injection), a connection pool (HikariCP) in real apps, `setAutoCommit(false)` + `commit`/`rollback` for transactions. SQL itself: the SQL handbook.

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## 20.17 Interview question index

The coding side — the Java DSA toolkit (§19.1–§19.7) and twenty patterns from two pointers to math and geometry (§19.8–§19.27) — is in the same chapter. Pattern finder:

| Problem says… | Pattern | Section |
|---|---|---|
| sorted input, pair with target sum, in place | two pointers | §19.8 |
| longest/shortest contiguous substring or subarray | sliding window | §19.9 |
| seen before, count, group, pair in unsorted data | hashing | §19.10 |
| range sums, subarrays summing to k (negatives allowed) | prefix sums | §19.11 |
| brackets, next greater element | stack / monotonic stack | §19.12 |
| k largest, merge k lists, running median, best among currently eligible | heap, two heaps | §19.13 |
| sorted, first true, minimum capacity such that | binary search (on the answer) | §19.14 |
| meetings, overlaps, rooms | intervals | §19.15 |
| fewest steps, islands, weighted route | BFS / DFS / Dijkstra | §19.16 |
| prerequisites, order with dependencies | topological sort | §19.17 |
| connected groups as edges arrive | union-find | §19.18 |
| number of ways, min cost, longest subsequence | dynamic programming | §19.19 |
| all subsets, permutations, N-Queens | backtracking | §19.20 |
| many prefix queries, autocomplete | trie | §19.21 |
| k-th from end, middle, cycle start, intersection, palindrome list | linked lists, fast/slow pointers | §19.22 |
| validate BST, lowest common ancestor, path sum, serialise | tree recursion (top-down / bottom-up) | §19.23 |
| jump game, gas station, candies, local best is safe | greedy | §19.24 |
| k-th element without full sort, sort colours, sort a list | quickselect, Dutch flag, merge sort | §19.25 |
| appears twice except one, count 1-bits, subsets of ≤ 20 | bit manipulation | §19.26 |
| spiral matrix, reverse digits, points on a line, Josephus | math and geometry | §19.27 |

**Language questions.** The full bank is Chapter 21 (Q1–Q280 by topic: basics, OOP, strings, `equals`/`hashCode`, exceptions, generics, collections, lambdas, streams, modern Java, concurrency, JVM, I/O, testing, scenarios, output puzzles, coding tasks, DSA and multithreading problems). §19.29 condenses the 42 most-asked into short answers keyed to that bank: Q1–12 strings, objects and the language · Q13–22 collections · Q23–25 exceptions · Q26–30 generics, lambdas and streams · Q31–36 concurrency · Q37–42 the JVM.

More interview material: each chapter's **In the interview** sections, the modern-Java round in §17.13, and exam-level traps in the OCP Java 21 study notes.

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## 20.18 Where next

| Direction | First step |
|---|---|
| **Spring Boot** (4.0, Nov 2025, on Spring Framework 7; Java 17+: DI, auto-configuration, starters, Actuator — §18.14) | build a small REST API at start.spring.io with JDBC or JPA, tested with JUnit, Mockito and Testcontainers |
| **Jakarta EE** (formerly Java EE: Servlet, CDI, JPA, JAX-RS, Bean Validation on WildFly, Open Liberty, Payara) | learn JPA and CDI — Spring uses many of the same specifications |
| **Quarkus, Micronaut, Helidon** (fast start-up, small memory, GraalVM native images) | port your Spring REST API to compare |
| **Kotlin** (JetBrains JVM language, Java-interoperable; null-safe types, data classes, coroutines; Android's preferred language since 2019); also Scala, Groovy, Clojure if a job needs them | rewrite one small program; call it from Java |
| **Android** (Kotlin-first, Java supported) | Android Developers' basic course |
| **Data and messaging** (JDBC/JPA, Kafka clients, Spark, Flink) | the SQL handbook and the DDIA notes |
| **Design** (SOLID, patterns, LLD case studies in Java) | the LLD handbook |
| **Certification** (Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 21 Developer, 1Z0-830) | the OCP Java 21 study notes |
| **Performance** (JFR, JMH, GC tuning, async-profiler) | revisit Chapter 16 with a real service |

Keep up to date by reading the JEP list for each release on openjdk.org and the dev.java articles; a new feature release ships every March and September.

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## 20.19 Glossary (A–Z)

Each term has a short definition and a link to the section that teaches it. Backticks and symbols are ignored when sorting; *italic* names point to another entry. 685 terms.

**A**

- **Abstract class** — A class declared `abstract` that can't be instantiated; it may hold state, constructors and abstract methods for subclasses to implement. §6.5
- **Abstract method** — A method with no body that a concrete subclass (or implementing class) must implement. §6.5
- **Access modifier** — `private`, package-private (none), `protected` or `public` — controls where a member can be used. §5.6
- **Accessor (record)** — The generated method named like a record component, e.g. `x()` for `record Point(int x, int y)`. §6.8
- **Actuator** — The Spring Boot module that exposes health, metrics and info endpoints for operations. §18.14
- **Adjacency list** — A graph stored as, for each node, the list of nodes it has an edge to. §19.16
- **Algebraic data type** — A type defined as "exactly one of these variants, each with these fields" — in Java, a sealed interface plus records. §3.7, §6.7
- **Algorithm** — A precise, step-by-step procedure that solves a problem; its cost is described with *Big-O notation*. Ch 19
- **Allocation rate** — How fast a program creates new objects (MB per second); a high rate means more frequent young collections. §16.10
- **Amortised O(1)** — Constant cost on average over many calls, even if an occasional call (such as an `ArrayList` resize) is O(n). §10.12
- **Anagram** — A word made by rearranging another word's letters (*tea*, *eat*); grouped by sorting each word's letters. §19.10

- **Annotation** — Metadata written `@Name` on code (`@Override`, `@FunctionalInterface`, `@Test`) that the compiler, tools or frameworks read. §6.3, §18.4
- **Anonymous class** — A class declared and instantiated in one expression, `new Interface() { … }`, with no name. §6.11
- **AOT cache** — Ahead-of-time class loading and linking data (Java 24–25) that the JVM reuses to start faster. §17.9, §17.10
- **API** — Application Programming Interface: the classes and methods a library, the JDK or a service offers for other code to call. §1.1
- `ArithmeticException` — Unchecked exception for integer division by zero or overflow detected by `Math.*Exact` methods. §2.10, §7.5
- **Arrange–Act–Assert** — The three-part shape of a clear test: set up the inputs, run the code under test, then check the result. §18.9
- **Array** — A fixed-length, indexed, zero-based container of one element type; an object with a `length` field. §4.6
- `ArrayDeque` — A resizable circular-array `Deque`; the recommended stack and queue; rejects `null`. §10.6
- `ArrayIndexOutOfBoundsException` — Thrown when an array index is negative or ≥ `length`. §4.6
- `ArrayList` — A growable-array `List` with O(1) indexed access and amortised O(1) append; the default list. §10.2
- `Arrays.asList` — Returns a fixed-size `List` view backed by an array: `set` writes through, `add`/`remove` throw. §4.8, §10.10
- **Arrow label** — `case X ->` in a `switch` (Java 14): runs only that case, with no fall-through. §3.3
- **ASCII** — The original 7-bit character set of 128 English letters, digits and symbols; the first 128 Unicode characters are the same. §7.1, §13.7
- `assert` — A statement that checks a condition only when the JVM runs with `-ea`; disabled by default. §19.1
- **AssertJ** — A fluent assertion library: `assertThat(x).isEqualTo(y)`. §18.7
- **Associativity** — The grouping order for operators of equal precedence — left for most, right for assignment and the ternary. §2.9
- **Asynchronous** — Started now and finished later without the caller waiting; the result arrives through a `Future`, a callback or a `CompletableFuture`. §15.1, §15.2
- **Atomic variable** — A class such as `AtomicInteger` whose single-variable updates are atomic without locks, using CAS. §14.10
- **Atomicity** — An operation is atomic when other threads can see it only as not started or fully done, never half-done. §14.5
- **Autoboxing / boxing / unboxing** — Automatic conversion from a primitive to its *wrapper class* (`int` → `Integer`, boxing) and back (unboxing); unboxing `null` throws `NullPointerException`. §7.6
- `AutoCloseable` — The interface with `close()` that try-with-resources calls automatically. §8.6

**B**

- **Backing array** — The array behind an `ArrayList` or an `Arrays.asList` view. §10.2, §10.10
- **Backtracking** — Searching every candidate solution by making a choice, exploring further, then undoing the choice to try the next one. §19.20
- **Banker's rounding** — `RoundingMode.HALF_EVEN`: a tie rounds to the even neighbour (2.345 → 2.34), which avoids drift in large sums. §7.7
- **Behaviour parameterisation** — Passing behaviour (today, a lambda) as an argument so one method can serve many cases. §11.1
- **Bellman-Ford** — A shortest-path algorithm that, unlike Dijkstra's, allows negative edge weights; slower at O(V · E). §19.16
- **Benchmark** — A measured timing of code; a fair Java microbenchmark needs warm-up and a harness such as *JMH*. §16.9
- **BFS (breadth-first search)** — Visiting a graph level by level from a start node using a queue; it finds shortest paths when every edge costs the same. §19.16

- `BigDecimal` — Immutable arbitrary-precision decimal number with an explicit scale; used for money. §7.7
- `BigInteger` — Immutable arbitrary-size integer. §7.7
- **Big-O notation** — How an operation's cost grows with input size n: O(1), O(log n), O(n), O(n log n), O(n²). §10.12, §19.7
- **Binary search** — Finding a key in sorted data by halving the range each step, O(log n). §4.8, §19.14
- **Binary search tree (BST)** — A binary tree where every key in a node's left subtree is smaller, and every key in its right subtree larger, than the node's key. §19.23
- **Binary tree** — A tree in which every node has at most two children, called left and right. §19.23
- **Bit manipulation** — Solving problems with bitwise operators on the binary form of integers — masks, shifts and xor tricks. §19.26
- **Bitmask** — An integer whose individual bits act as on/off flags, for example one bit per item of a subset. §19.26
- **Bitwise operators** — `&`, `\|`, `^`, `~`, `<<`, `>>`, `>>>` — operate on the individual bits of integers. §2.8
- `BLOCKED` — The thread state of a thread waiting to acquire a monitor held by another thread. §14.3
- `BlockingQueue` — A queue whose `put` waits when full and `take` waits when empty; the core of producer–consumer. §14.12
- **BOM** — (1) Byte order mark: optional bytes at the start of a text file that announce its encoding. (2) In Maven, a "bill of materials" POM that pins versions for a family of libraries. §13.7, §18.2
- **Bootstrap class loader** — The JVM's built-in loader for core modules such as `java.base`; shown as `null` by `getClassLoader()`. §16.2
- **Bounded type parameter** — A type parameter with a limit, e.g. `<T extends Number>`. §9.5
- `break` — Leaves the innermost loop or `switch` (or a labelled statement with `break label`). §3.9
- **Bridge method** — A hidden method `javac` generates so that overriding still works after generic types are erased. §9.7
- **Brute force** — Solving a problem by trying every possibility; usually too slow, but a good first answer to improve on. §19.28
- **Bucket** — One slot of a hash table's array, holding the entries whose hashes map to that index. §10.5
- **Buffer / buffering** — A block of memory that collects data so it is read or written in large chunks, avoiding many slow system calls. §13.6, §13.9
- **Build tool** — Software (Maven, Gradle) that resolves dependencies, compiles, tests and packages a project. §18.2, §18.3
- **Byte Buddy** — A library for generating and changing classes at run time; Mockito uses it to build mocks. §17.12
- **Byte stream** — `InputStream`/`OutputStream`: I/O in raw 8-bit bytes. §13.5
- `ByteBuffer` — A NIO container of bytes with position, limit and capacity, used with channels. §13.9
- **Bytecode** — The platform-independent instruction set in `.class` files that the JVM executes. §1.6

**C**

- **C1 / C2** — HotSpot's two JIT compilers: C1 compiles quickly with light optimisation, C2 slowly with heavy optimisation. §1.7, §16.8
- **Cache** — A fast store of recently used or precomputed results kept so the next request is cheaper; it needs a size limit or eviction rule, or it becomes a memory leak. §10.4, §16.11, System Design Fundamentals
- **Call stack** — The stack of frames for the method calls a thread currently has in progress: a call pushes a frame, a return pops it. §4.5, §16.3
- `Callable` — A task interface `V call() throws Exception` that returns a value; see `Runnable`. §14.11
- **Callback** — A function handed to other code so that code can call it later, for example the lambda given to `thenApply`. §15.1, §15.2
- **Canonical constructor** — A record's constructor that takes every component in declaration order; generated unless you write it. §6.8

- **Card table / remembered set** — GC bookkeeping that records which old-generation areas point into the young generation, so a young collection needn't scan the whole heap. §16.5
- **Carrier thread** — A platform thread on which the JVM mounts virtual threads to run them. §15.4
- **CAS (compare-and-set)** — An atomic CPU instruction that updates a value only if it still equals an expected value. §14.10
- **Casting** — Explicit conversion `(Type) value` — narrowing a primitive, or checking an object's run-time type. §2.7, §6.4
- **CDI** — Jakarta Contexts and Dependency Injection: the Jakarta EE standard for dependency injection. §1.2
- **CDS (Class Data Sharing)** — Saving already-parsed classes in an archive that later JVM runs map in, so they start faster; the *AOT cache* builds on it. §16.2
- **Channel** — An NIO connection to a file or socket (such as `FileChannel`) that reads and writes through `ByteBuffer`s. §13.9
- **`char`** — The 16-bit unsigned primitive holding one UTF-16 code unit (0 … 65 535). §2.3
- **Character stream** — `Reader`/`Writer`: I/O in 16-bit characters, decoded with a charset. §13.5
- **Charset (encoding)** — The rules mapping characters to bytes and back, such as UTF-8; the JDK default since Java 18 is UTF-8. §13.7
- **Checked exception** — An `Exception` outside the `RuntimeException` branch; must be caught or declared with `throws`. §8.2, §8.3
- **Check-then-act** — Testing a condition and then acting on it as two separate steps; another thread can change things in between, so the pair must be made atomic. §14.5
- **CI (continuous integration)** — A server that automatically builds and tests every change pushed to a shared repository. §18.1, §18.2
- **Circular array** — An array used as a ring whose indexes wrap from the end back to the start, so a queue can grow at both ends cheaply (`ArrayDeque`). §10.6
- **Class** — A blueprint that defines fields, constructors and methods; objects are its instances. §5.1
- **Class file** — The `.class` file `javac` produces, containing bytecode and a constant pool. §1.6
- **Class initialisation** — Running a class's static field initialisers and `static {}` blocks, once, on first active use. §5.10, §16.2
- **Class loader** — The object that finds and loads class bytes; loaders delegate to their parent first. §16.2
- **Class path** — The list of directories and JARs where the JVM looks for classes (`-cp`). §1.5
- **Class-File API** — The `java.lang.classfile` API (final in Java 24) for reading and writing class files. §17.9
- **`Clock`** — `java.time.Clock`: a replaceable source of "now"; inject it so tests can fix the time. §7.8, §18.9
- **Closure** — A function together with the variables it captured from its surrounding scope; lambdas capture effectively final locals. §11.5
- **Code cache** — Memory where the JIT stores compiled machine code. §16.3
- **Code coverage** — The share of lines or branches that the tests execute, measured with tools such as JaCoCo; high coverage doesn't prove good tests. §18.9
- **Code point** — The number Unicode gives one character; a code point above U+FFFF needs two `char`s (a *surrogate pair*) in Java. §7.2
- **Code unit** — One 16-bit `char` of UTF-16 text; most characters take one code unit, some take two. §2.3, §7.2
- **Coffman conditions** — The four conditions that must all hold for a deadlock: mutual exclusion, hold and wait, no preemption, circular wait. Break any one to prevent it. §15.9
- **Collection** — The root interface of lists, sets and queues (maps are separate). §10.1
- **`Collections`** — Utility class with `sort`, `reverse`, `shuffle`, `frequency`, `unmodifiableList` and more. §10.9
- **Collector** — A recipe for accumulating stream elements into a result, e.g. `groupingBy`, `toMap`, `joining`. §12.5

- **Coloured pointers** — ZGC's trick of storing a few GC status bits inside object references themselves. §16.5
- **Compact constructor** — A record constructor without a parameter list, used to validate or normalise components. §6.8
- **Compact object headers** — Java 25 option (`-XX:+UseCompactObjectHeaders`) that shrinks object headers from 12 to 8 bytes; on by default from JDK 27. §16.4, §17.10
- **Compact source file** — A Java 25 source file with top-level methods and no class declaration; run with `java File.java`. §4.9, §17.10
- **Compaction** — Moving live objects next to each other so free memory forms one large block. §16.5
- `Comparable` — Interface whose `compareTo` defines a class's natural order. §10.8
- `Comparator` — A separate object whose `compare` defines an ordering; built with `comparing`, `thenComparing`, `reversed`. §10.8
- **Compiler** — A program that translates source code into another form: `javac` turns Java into bytecode, the JIT turns bytecode into machine code. §1.5, §1.7
- **Compile-time constant** — A `final` primitive or `String` initialised with a constant expression; folded by `javac`. §7.1
- `CompletableFuture` — A `Future` you can complete manually and compose asynchronously (`thenApply`, `thenCompose`, `allOf`). §15.2
- `CompletionException` — The unchecked wrapper `CompletableFuture.join()` throws when the computation failed. §15.2
- **Composition** — Building a class from other objects held in fields and delegating work to them — often preferred to inheritance. §6.1
- **Compound assignment** — Operators such as `+=`, which include an implicit cast back to the variable's type. §2.8
- **Compressed oops** — Storing object references in 32 bits on a 64-bit JVM (heaps up to about 32 GB) to save memory. §16.4
- **Concurrency** — Several tasks in progress over the same period, possibly interleaved on one core. §14.1
- **Concurrent collection** — A collection from `java.util.concurrent`, such as `ConcurrentHashMap` or `BlockingQueue`, designed for safe use by many threads at once. §14.12
- `ConcurrentHashMap` — A thread-safe, highly scalable hash map with atomic `merge`/`compute`; no `null` keys or values. §14.12
- `ConcurrentModificationException` **(CME)** — Thrown by fail-fast iterators when a collection is structurally changed during iteration. §10.7
- `Condition` — A waiting queue tied to an explicit `Lock` (`await`, `signal`); one lock can have several conditions. §14.9
- **Connected component** — A group of graph nodes that can all reach each other; counted with DFS, BFS or union-find. §19.16, §19.18
- **Connection pool** — A set of open database connections reused across requests, because opening one is slow (e.g. HikariCP). §18.11
- **Constant folding** — The compiler working out a constant expression such as `"ja" + "va"` at compile time. §7.1
- **Constant pool** — The table inside a class file that holds the literals and symbolic names its bytecode refers to. §1.6
- **Constructor** — A special method with the class's name that initialises a new object. §5.3
- **Constructor chaining** — Calling another constructor with `this(...)` or the parent's with `super(...)`. §5.3, §6.1
- **Container** — A lightweight, isolated package of an application with its own CPU and memory limits (e.g. Docker); the JVM reads those limits to size itself. §16.3, §16.7
- **Context switch** — The OS pausing one thread and running another on the same CPU core. §14.1
- `continue` — Skips to the next iteration of the innermost (or labelled) loop. §3.9
- `CopyOnWriteArrayList` — A thread-safe list that copies its array on every write; iterators see a snapshot. §14.12

- `CountDownLatch` — A one-shot synchronizer: threads `await()` until `countDown()` has been called n times. §14.13
- **Covariant return type** — An overriding method may return a subtype of the overridden method's return type. §6.3
- **CPU** — Central processing unit: the processor that executes instructions; its cores each run one thread at a time. §14.1
- **CPU-bound** — Work limited by computation rather than by waiting for I/O; more threads than cores won't speed it up. §12.8, §15.4
- **Critical section** — Code that touches shared mutable state and must not run in two threads at once. §14.1
- **Currying** — Turning a function of several arguments into a chain of one-argument functions. §11.8
- `CyclicBarrier` — A reusable synchronizer where n threads wait for each other before all continue. §14.13

**D**

- **Daemon thread** — A background thread that doesn't keep the JVM alive; virtual threads are always daemon. §14.2
- **DAG (directed acyclic graph)** — A graph whose edges have a direction and that contains no cycle; it always has a topological order. §19.17
- **Dangling else** — The question of which `if` an `else` belongs to when braces are missing; Java pairs it with the nearest `if`. §3.1
- **Data race** — Two threads access the same variable without a happens-before order and at least one writes. §15.8
- **Data structure** — A way of organising data in memory — array, list, hash table, tree, heap — chosen for the operations you need to be fast. §10.1, Ch 19
- `DateTimeFormatter` — Immutable, thread-safe formatter and parser for `java.time` values. §7.11
- **Daylight saving time (DST)** — The seasonal shift of clocks in many regions, which makes some local times skip or repeat. §7.10
- **Dead-code elimination** — The JIT removing computation whose result is never used — the classic trap in hand-written benchmarks. §16.9
- **Deadlock** — Threads wait forever for locks each other holds. §15.9
- **Declarative style** — Describing what result you want (filter, map, group) instead of writing the loop that produces it. §11.8, §12.11
- **Decorator** — A wrapper that adds behaviour to an object while offering the same interface, e.g. `BufferedReader` around a `Reader`. §13.5
- **Default constructor** — The no-argument constructor the compiler adds when a class declares no constructor. §5.3
- **Default method** — An interface method with a body (Java 8), inherited by implementing classes unless overridden. §6.6
- **Default value** — The initial value of a field or array element: `0`, `false` or `null`; local variables have none. §2.2, §2.3
- **Defensive copy** — Copying a mutable input or output so outside code can't change an object's internal state. §5.9
- **Definite assignment** — The compiler rule that a local variable must certainly have been assigned before it is read. §2.2
- **Deoptimisation** — The JIT discarding compiled code whose speculative assumptions stopped holding. §16.8
- **Dependency** — A library your project uses; build tools download it together with the libraries it needs in turn. §18.1, §18.2
- **Dependency injection** — Supplying an object's collaborators from outside (usually through the constructor) instead of creating them inside. §18.6, §18.14
- `Deque` — A double-ended queue: insert and remove at both ends; used as stack or queue. §10.6
- **Deserialisation** — Rebuilding objects from bytes; dangerous with untrusted input. §13.10

- **Devirtualisation** — The JIT replacing an overridable (virtual) call with a direct call when only one implementation has been seen. §16.8
- **DFS (depth-first search)** — Visiting a graph by following each path as deep as possible before backing up, using recursion or an explicit stack. §19.16
- **Diamond operator** — `<>` in `new HashMap<>()` — lets the compiler infer the type arguments. §9.2
- **Difference array** — An array of "change starts here" marks: add v at l and −v at r + 1, then one running sum applies every range update. §19.11
- **Dijkstra's algorithm** — Finds the cheapest paths from one node in a graph with non-negative edge weights, using a priority queue. §19.16
- **Direct memory** — Native memory outside the heap used by direct `ByteBuffer`s. §16.3
- **Divide and conquer** — Splitting a problem into smaller parts, solving each (often recursively or in parallel) and combining the results. §4.5, §15.3
- **Docker** — The most widely used tool for building and running containers. §16.3, §18.9
- `double` — The 64-bit IEEE 754 floating-point primitive; the default for decimals. §2.3, §2.11
- `do-while` — A loop that runs its body once before testing the condition. §3.8
- **Downcasting / upcasting** — Upcasting treats an object as one of its supertypes (automatic); downcasting casts back to a subtype and can throw `ClassCastException`. §6.4
- **Downstream collector** — A collector applied to each group inside `groupingBy` or `partitioningBy`, such as `counting()`. §12.5
- **DSA** — Data structures and algorithms — the subject of coding interviews. Ch 19
- **DSL** — Domain-specific language: a small language for one job, such as Gradle's Kotlin build scripts. §18.3
- **DTO** — Data transfer object: a plain data carrier passed between layers or over the network; a record is a natural fit. §6.8
- **Dummy node / sentinel** — A special marker value (such as −1 for "not seen") or a placeholder node in front of a linked list's head that removes a special case from the code. §19.11, §19.22
- `Duration` — A `java.time` amount of time in seconds and nanoseconds (e.g. `PT1H30M`). §7.10
- **Dutch national flag** — Splitting an array into three regions (less than, equal to, greater than a value) in one pass. §19.25
- **Dynamic dispatch** — Choosing which overridden method to run from the object's run-time class. §6.4
- **Dynamic programming (DP)** — Solving a problem from the answers to overlapping smaller subproblems, computing each answer once (memoisation or tabulation). §19.19

**E**

- **Eclipse Temurin** — The Adoptium project's free, widely used OpenJDK build. §1.2
- **Eden** — The part of the young generation where new objects are first allocated. §16.5
- **Effectively final** — A local variable that is never reassigned after initialisation; lambdas may capture only these. §11.5
- **Encapsulation** — Hiding an object's state behind methods so its invariants can't be broken from outside. §5.7
- **Encounter order** — The order in which a stream meets its elements: a `List` has one, a `HashSet` does not. §12.4
- **Endianness** — The byte order of multi-byte numbers: big-endian (Java's default) stores the most significant byte first. §13.9
- **End-to-end test** — A test of the whole running system through its real entry points, as a user would use it. §18.9
- **Enhanced** `for` — The for-each loop, `for (T x : iterable)`. §3.8
- **Enum** — A type with a fixed set of named instances; may have fields, constructors and methods. §6.9
- `EnumMap` / `EnumSet` — Very compact, fast map/set implementations for enum keys/elements. §10.4, §10.3
- **Environment variable** — A named setting the operating system passes to every program it starts, such as `JAVA_HOME` or `PATH`. §1.4

- **Epoch** — The fixed instant 1970-01-01T00:00:00Z from which `Instant` and `System.currentTimeMillis()` count. §7.10
- **Epsilon GC** — A no-op collector that never frees memory; for testing. §16.5
- `equals` — The method that defines logical equality; must be consistent with `hashCode`. §6.13
- **Equivalence class** — A group of inputs that the code treats the same way, so one test (plus the boundaries) covers it. §18.9
- `Error` — The `Throwable` branch for serious JVM problems such as `OutOfMemoryError`; unchecked, normally not caught. §8.2
- **Escape analysis** — A JIT analysis proving an object doesn't leave a method, enabling scalar replacement and lock elision. §16.8
- **Escape sequence** — A backslash code for a special character in a literal: `\n`, `\t`, `\"`, `\\`, `\A`. §2.4
- **Exception** — An object signalling an abnormal condition, thrown with `throw` and caught with `catch`. §8.1
- **Exception chaining** — Wrapping a low-level exception as the cause of a higher-level one. §8.8
- **Exception translation** — Catching an exception at a layer boundary and throwing one that fits the higher layer's abstraction. §8.8
- **Executable JAR** — A JAR whose manifest names a `Main-Class`, so it runs with `java -jar app.jar`. §18.12
- `ExecutorService` — A thread-pool abstraction that accepts tasks and returns `Future`s; `AutoCloseable` since Java 19. §14.11
- **Exhaustive switch** — A `switch` whose cases cover every possible value (all enum constants, all permitted subtypes, or `default`). §3.3, §3.6
- **Explicit lock** — A `java.util.concurrent.locks.Lock` such as `ReentrantLock`, acquired and released in code. §14.9
- **Expression** — Code that produces a value, such as `a + b`, `x > 0` or a method call; a statement is a complete instruction. §2.1

**F**

- **Factory method** — A static method that creates instances (`List.of`, `Integer.valueOf`); unlike a constructor it has a name and may cache or return a subtype. §5.3
- **Fail-fast iterator** — An iterator that throws `ConcurrentModificationException` on a best-effort basis when its collection changes structurally. §10.7
- **Failure atomicity** — A method that fails leaves its object exactly as it was before the call. §8.7, §8.10
- **Fair lock** — A lock that grants access in waiting order, avoiding starvation at some cost in speed. §14.9
- **Fake** — A working but simplified test double, such as an in-memory repository. §18.6
- **Fall-through** — In a classic `case X:` switch, execution running on into the next case when there is no `break`. §3.2
- **Fast and slow pointers (Floyd's cycle-finding algorithm)** — Two references moving through a list at different speeds (1 and 2 steps): fast reaching the end puts slow at the middle; they meet only if there is a cycle. §19.22
- **Fat JAR** — A single JAR containing the application and all of its dependencies (also "uber JAR"). §18.12
- **Feature release** — One of the two Java versions released every year, in March and September. §1.12
- **Field** — A variable declared in a class that holds an object's state (or, if `static`, the class's). §5.1
- **FIFO / LIFO** — First in, first out (a queue) / last in, first out (a stack). §10.1, §10.6
- **File descriptor** — The operating system's small-integer handle for an open file or socket; each process may hold only a limited number. §16.13
- `final` — Modifier: a final variable is assigned once, a final method can't be overridden, a final class can't be extended. §5.8
- **Finalization** — The deprecated-for-removal `finalize()` mechanism (Java 18, JEP 421); use try-with-resources or `Cleaner`. §17.12

- **`finally`** — A block after `try` that always runs when control leaves the `try`. §8.4
- **Flaky test** — A test that sometimes passes and sometimes fails with no code change, usually because of timing, randomness or shared state. §18.9
- **Flexible constructor bodies** — Java 25 feature allowing statements that don't use `this` before `super(...)` or `this(...)`. §17.10
- **`float`** — The 32-bit IEEE 754 floating-point primitive (~7 significant digits). §2.3
- **Floating-point error** — Rounding error because binary fractions can't represent most decimals exactly (`0.1 + 0.2`). §2.11
- **Foreign Function & Memory API** — The `java.lang.foreign` API (final in Java 22) to call native code and manage off-heap memory, replacing JNI. §17.7
- **Fork/Join** — A framework for recursive divide-and-conquer tasks run by a work-stealing `ForkJoinPool`. §15.3
- **Formatter specifier** — A pattern such as `%5.2f` or `%-10s` in `String.format`/`printf`. §7.4
- **Fragile base class** — A subclass breaking because its superclass's internals changed — a risk of inheritance across teams or libraries. §6.1
- **Frame (stack frame)** — The record one method call keeps on its thread's stack: parameters, local variables and where to return. §4.5, §16.3
- **`fsync`** — An operating-system call that forces written data out of memory caches onto the disk. §16.13
- **Full GC** — A collection of the whole heap, usually with a long stop-the-world pause. §16.5
- **Functional interface** — An interface with exactly one abstract method; a lambda or method reference can implement it. §11.2
- **Functional programming** — A style built from pure functions, immutable data and functions passed around as values. §11.8
- **`Future`** — A handle to an asynchronous result, obtained with a blocking `get()`. §15.1

**G**

- **GA (general availability)** — The official release of a Java version for production use. §20.15
- **Garbage collection (GC)** — Automatic reclamation of memory used by objects that are no longer reachable. §1.8, §16.5
- **Garbage-First (G1)** — The default collector since Java 9 (in all environments from JDK 27); region-based, with a pause-time goal. §16.5
- **Gatherer (stream gatherers)** — A custom intermediate stream operation used with `stream.gather(...)` (final in Java 24). §12.9
- **GC roots** — Starting points for reachability: thread stacks, static fields, JNI references. §16.5
- **GCD / LCM** — Greatest common divisor (the largest number dividing both) / least common multiple (the smallest number both divide). §19.27
- **Generational hypothesis** — Most objects die young, so collectors split the heap into young and old generations. §16.5
- **Generic method** — A method that declares its own type parameters: `static <T> T first(List<T> xs)`. §9.4
- **Generics** — Type parameters on classes, interfaces and methods for compile-time type safety without casts. §9.1
- **Getter / setter** — Methods that read (`getName()`) or change (`setName(...)`) a private field. §5.7
- **GIL** — Python's global interpreter lock, which lets one thread run Python code at a time; Java has none, so its threads truly run in parallel. §14.14
- **GraalVM** — Oracle's JDK distribution with an advanced JIT and *Native Image*. §1.2, §18.14
- **Gradle** — A build tool using a Groovy or Kotlin DSL with incremental, cached tasks. §18.3
- **Graph** — A set of nodes joined by edges, which may have a direction and a weight (cost); trees, grids and road maps are graphs. §19.16
- **Greedy algorithm** — Building an answer by always taking the choice that looks best right now and never undoing it; correct only when the greedy-choice property holds. §19.24
- **Greedy-choice property** — Some optimal answer starts with the locally best choice — the condition that makes a greedy algorithm correct. §19.24

- **Guard clause** — An early `return` (or `throw`) at the top of a method for special cases, keeping the main logic unindented. §3.1
- **Guard (pattern)** — A `when` condition attached to a `case` pattern. §3.6
- **GUI** — Graphical user interface: windows, buttons and menus. §16.10

**H**

- **Handle-or-declare rule** — A checked exception must be caught or listed in the method's `throws` clause. §8.3
- **Happens-before** — The Java Memory Model relation guaranteeing one action's effects are visible to another. §15.8
- **Hash table** — An array of buckets indexed by each key's hash code, giving O(1) average lookups; `HashMap` is one. §10.5
- **`hashCode`** — Returns an `int` used by hash-based collections; equal objects must return equal hash codes. §6.13
- **`HashMap`** — An unordered hash-table map with average O(1) operations; allows one `null` key. §10.4, §10.5
- **`HashSet`** — A set backed by a `HashMap`; unordered, average O(1). §10.3
- **Heap** — The JVM memory area where all objects and arrays live, shared by all threads and garbage-collected. §16.3
- **Heap (data structure)** — A tree kept in an array whose root is always the smallest (min-heap) or largest (max-heap) item; O(log n) insert and remove; `PriorityQueue` is a min-heap by default. Unrelated to the JVM *heap*. §10.6, §19.13
- **Heap dump** — A snapshot of every object in the heap, analysed with Eclipse MAT or VisualVM. §16.10, §16.11
- **Heap pollution** — A variable of a parameterized type referring to an object of the wrong type, caused by unchecked operations. §9.8
- **Helpful NullPointerException** — NPE messages that name exactly which expression was `null` (Java 14, on by default since 15). §8.1
- **Hexadecimal** — Base-16 notation with digits 0–9 and a–f, written `0x2A` in Java. §2.4
- **Hibernate** — The most popular JPA implementation, which maps Java objects to database tables. §18.11, §18.14
- **Hiding** — A static method or field in a subclass with the same name as the parent's; chosen by compile-time type, not overridden. §6.2
- **Higher-order function** — A function that takes or returns another function, such as `map` or `Comparator.comparing`. §11.8
- **HikariCP** — A fast JDBC connection pool; Spring Boot's default. §18.11
- **HotSpot** — The JVM inside OpenJDK and most Java distributions, named after its compilation of "hot" code. §1.3
- **HTTP** — Hypertext Transfer Protocol: the request/response protocol of the web, spoken by browsers, REST APIs and Java's `HttpClient`. §18.14
- **Humongous object** — In G1, an object at least half a region in size, which gets regions of its own. §16.5

**I**

- **IDE** — Integrated development environment, such as IntelliJ IDEA, Eclipse or VS Code: editor, compiler, debugger and tools in one. §1.11
- **Identity** — Whether two references point to the very same object (`==`), as opposed to being equal in value (`equals`). §6.13
- **`IdentityHashMap` / `WeakHashMap`** — Special maps: `IdentityHashMap` compares keys with `==`; `WeakHashMap` drops an entry once nothing else references its key. §10.4
- **IEEE 754** — The international standard for binary floating-point numbers that `float` and `double` follow. §2.11
- **`IllegalArgumentException`** — Unchecked exception for a method argument that violates a precondition. §8.7

- **`IllegalStateException`** — Unchecked exception for a call made when the object is in the wrong state. §8.7
- **Immutable object** — An object whose state can't change after construction (the opposite of **mutable**), such as `String` or a record of immutable values. §5.9
- **Incidental indentation** — The common leading whitespace that a text block strips from every line. §2.12
- **Incubator module** — An experimental API in a `jdk.incubator.*` module, e.g. the Vector API. §17.1
- **In-degree** — The number of edges pointing into a node; Kahn's algorithm starts from the nodes with in-degree 0. §19.17
- **Inheritance** — A subclass acquiring a superclass's members with `extends`; Java has single class inheritance. §6.1
- **Initialisation order** — Static initialisers once per class, then for each object: parent constructor, field initialisers and instance blocks, constructor body. §5.10
- **Inlining** — The JIT copying a callee's body into its caller to remove call overhead and enable further optimisation. §16.8
- **Inner class** — A non-static nested class; each instance holds a reference to an enclosing instance. §6.10
- **In-place** — Changing the input directly with O(1) extra memory instead of building a new copy. §19.8
- **Instance** — An object created from a class; instance members belong to each object, `static` ones to the class. §5.1
- **Instance initialiser block** — A `{ … }` block in a class body that runs for every new object, before the rest of the constructor body. §5.10
- **Instance main method** — A Java 25 `main` that is not `static` and may take no parameters: `void main()`. §4.9, §17.10
- **`instanceof`** — Operator testing an object's run-time type; with a pattern it also binds a variable (Java 16). §3.5
- **`Instant`** — A point on the UTC time-line, stored as seconds and nanoseconds since the epoch; use it for timestamps. §7.10
- **`int`** — The 32-bit signed integer primitive, range $-2^{31}$ … $2^{31}-1$. §2.3
- **`Integer` cache** — `Integer.valueOf` returns cached objects for −128 … 127, so `==` happens to work only in that range. §7.6
- **Integer division** — Dividing two integers drops the fraction, rounding toward zero: `7 / 2` is 3 and `-7 / 2` is −3. §2.8, §19.6
- **Integer overflow** — A result outside a type's range wraps around silently (`Integer.MAX_VALUE + 1` is `MIN_VALUE`). §2.10
- **Integration test** — A test that runs several real parts together (for example code plus a real database) instead of one class in isolation. §18.9
- **IntelliJ IDEA** — JetBrains' widely used Java IDE. §1.11
- **Interface** — A contract type: abstract, default, static and private methods plus constants; a class can implement many. §6.6
- **Intermediate operation** — A lazy stream operation such as `filter` or `map` that returns a new stream. §12.3
- **Interning** — Obtaining the pooled copy of a string with `intern()`. §7.1
- **Interpreter** — The JVM component that executes bytecode instruction by instruction before the JIT compiles hot code. §1.7
- **Interruption** — Cooperative cancellation: `interrupt()` sets a flag that blocking methods answer with `InterruptedException`. §14.4
- **Interval** — A range with a start and an end, such as a meeting `[9, 11)`; interval problems usually sort by start and sweep. §19.15
- **Invariance (generics)** — `List<Integer>` is not a `List<Number>` even though `Integer` is a `Number`; wildcards add the flexibility back. §9.6
- **Invariant** — A condition that must always hold — for an object after every public method, or for a loop on every iteration. §5.7

- **Inverse Ackermann function** — α(n), a function that grows so slowly it is below 5 for any realistic n; union-find costs O(α(n)) per operation. §19.18
- `invokedynamic` — A bytecode instruction whose call target is linked at run time; Java uses it for lambdas and string concatenation. §1.6
- **I/O** — Input/output: reading and writing files, network sockets, the console and databases. §13.1
- `IO` **class** — `java.lang.IO` (Java 25): `println`, `print` and `readln` for simple console programs. §4.9, §17.10
- `Iterable` — Anything with an `iterator()`; usable in an enhanced `for`. §10.1, §10.7
- `Iterator` — An object with `hasNext`, `next` and optional `remove` for walking a collection. §10.7

**J**

- **Jackson / Gson** — Popular third-party libraries for reading and writing JSON in Java. §13.12
- **Jakarta EE** — The Eclipse Foundation's enterprise Java specifications (formerly Java EE): Servlet, JPA, CDI, REST. §1.2, §18.14
- **JAR** — A ZIP archive of class files and resources with a manifest; executable with `java -jar` when it names a `Main-Class`. §18.12
- **Java agent** — A JAR loaded with `-javaagent` that can change classes as they load (used by profilers and Mockito); loading one into a running JVM now prints a warning. §17.6, §18.6
- **Java Memory Model (JMM)** — The rules defining when writes by one thread become visible to others. §15.8
- **Java SE** — Java Standard Edition: the core language, JVM and standard library this book covers. §1.2
- `javac` — The Java compiler; turns `.java` source into `.class` bytecode. §1.5
- **Javadoc** — Documentation comments `/** … */` and the tool that turns them into HTML API pages. §1.5, §2.1
- `JAVA_HOME` — The environment variable naming the JDK directory that build tools should use. §1.4
- `java.time` — The modern date-time API (Java 8): immutable, thread-safe classes such as `LocalDate` and `Instant`. §7.8
- **JCIP** — *Java Concurrency in Practice*, the classic book on Java threads and locking. §14.4
- `jcmd` — The command-line tool that sends diagnostic commands to a running JVM. §16.10
- **JDBC** — The standard API for talking to relational databases: `Connection`, `PreparedStatement`, `ResultSet`. §18.11
- **JDK** — Java Development Kit: the JVM, the class library and tools such as `javac`, `jar`, `jshell`, `jcmd`. §1.3
- **JDK Mission Control (JMC)** — A desktop application for analysing JFR recordings. §16.10
- **JEP** — JDK Enhancement Proposal: the numbered document describing a new feature. §1.12, §17.1
- **JFR (JDK Flight Recorder)** — Low-overhead event recording built into the JVM, for production profiling. §16.10
- **JIT compiler** — Just-in-time compiler that turns hot bytecode into optimised machine code while the program runs. §1.7, §16.8
- `jlink` — Builds a custom runtime image containing only the modules an application needs. §16.12
- **JLS** — The Java Language Specification: the official definition of the language's rules. §4.3
- **JMH** — The Java Microbenchmark Harness, which handles warm-up, forks and dead-code elimination for benchmarks. §16.9
- **JMX** — Java Management Extensions: the JVM's API for publishing and reading monitoring data and controls. §16.1
- **JNI** — Java Native Interface: the older way to call C or C++ code from Java, being replaced by the *Foreign Function & Memory API*. §16.1
- **Josephus problem** — n people stand in a circle and every k-th is removed; the survivor's position follows J(n) = (J(n − 1) + k) mod n. §19.27
- **JPA** — Jakarta Persistence: the standard API for mapping objects to database tables, usually through Hibernate. §1.2, §18.14
- **JPMS** — The Java Platform Module System (Java 9): `module-info.java` with `requires`, `exports`, `opens`. §16.12

- **JRE** — Java Runtime Environment: the JVM plus class library, enough to run but not compile programs; since Java 11 Oracle ships only the JDK (trimmed runtimes are built with `jlink`). §1.3
- `jshell` — The Java REPL (Java 9) for trying expressions interactively. §1.9
- **JSON** — JavaScript Object Notation: a common text format of objects, arrays, strings and numbers for exchanging data. §13.12
- `jstack` — Prints a thread dump of a running JVM. §16.10
- **JUL** — Short for `java.util.logging`, the JDK's built-in logging API. §18.10
- **JUnit** — The standard Java testing framework (tests are `@Test` methods): the Platform discovers and launches tests, Jupiter is the modern test API, Vintage runs old JUnit 4 tests. §18.4
- **JVM** — Java Virtual Machine: loads, verifies and runs bytecode, manages memory and threads. §1.3, §16.1

**K**

- **Kafka** — A distributed, durable message log used to stream events between services. §20.18
- **Kahn's algorithm** — Topological sort by repeatedly taking a node with in-degree 0 and removing its outgoing edges. §19.17
- **Kernel** — The core of the operating system that manages memory, devices and scheduling; programs reach it through system calls. §16.13
- **Key derivation function API** — `javax.crypto.KDF` (Java 25) for deriving keys, e.g. with HKDF. §17.10
- **Keyword** — A word reserved by the language (`class`, `if`, `int`); contextual keywords such as `var` and `record` are special only in certain positions. §2.1
- **Kotlin** — A JetBrains language for the JVM that is fully interoperable with Java. §20.18
- **Kruskal's algorithm** — Building a minimum spanning tree by taking edges cheapest first and skipping any that would close a cycle (checked with union-find). §19.18

**L**

- **Label** — A name before a loop (`outer:`) that `break` or `continue` can target. §3.9
- **Lambda expression** — An anonymous function, `(params) -> body`, implementing a functional interface. §11.2
- **Latency** — The time one operation takes from start to finish — a request, a disk read, a GC pause. §16.5, §16.6, System Design Fundamentals
- **Lazy evaluation** — Deferring work until a result is needed; streams do nothing until a terminal operation runs. §12.2
- **LeetCode** — A popular website of coding-interview practice problems; "LeetCode-style" means a timed algorithm question. Ch 19
- **Lexicographic order** — Dictionary order: compare the first elements and look at the next ones only on a tie. §4.8
- **Lifecycle (Maven)** — Maven's fixed sequence of build phases (`validate` … `compile` … `test` … `package` … `deploy`); running a phase runs every earlier one. §18.2
- **Linked list** — A chain of nodes, each holding a value and a reference to the next node (and, if doubly linked, the previous one). §10.2, §19.22
- `LinkedHashMap` — A hash map that keeps insertion (or access) order; the basis of a simple LRU cache. §10.4
- `LinkedHashSet` — A hash set that remembers insertion order. §10.3
- `LinkedList` — A doubly linked `List` and `Deque`; O(1) at the ends, O(n) indexing. §10.2
- **Liskov substitution principle** — A subclass must work anywhere its parent is expected, without surprising the caller. §6.1
- `ListIterator` — An iterator over a `List` that can move in both directions and `set` or `add` elements as it goes. §10.2
- **Literal** — A value written directly in source code: `42`, `3.14`, `'a'`, `"hi"`, `true`. §2.4
- **Little's law** — Requests in flight = arrival rate × time per request; e.g. 1,000 requests/s each taking 0.1 s keep 100 busy at once. §15.4
- **Livelock** — Threads keep changing state in response to each other but make no progress. §15.9

- **Liveness** — A program's ability to keep making progress; deadlock, livelock and starvation are liveness failures. §15.9
- **Load average** — On Linux, the average number of threads running or waiting to run over the last 1, 5 and 15 minutes. §16.13
- **Load barrier** — A tiny piece of code ZGC adds to every reference read so it can move objects while the application keeps running. §16.5
- **Load factor** — The fullness ratio (default 0.75) at which a `HashMap` doubles its table. §10.5
- **Local class** — A class declared inside a method body. §6.11
- **`LocalDate`** — A date without time or zone, e.g. `2025-03-09`. §7.9
- **`LocalDateTime`** — A date and time without a zone. §7.9
- **Locale** — A language-and-region setting (`Locale.US`, `Locale.ROOT`) that controls number, date and case formatting. §7.2, §7.4
- **`LocalTime` / `OffsetDateTime`** — `LocalTime` is a time of day with no date or zone; `OffsetDateTime` is a date-time with a fixed offset from UTC. §7.8
- **Lock elision** — The JIT removing locking on objects proved not to escape their thread. §16.8
- **Lock ordering** — Always acquiring several locks in one agreed global order, which makes deadlock impossible. §15.9
- **Logback / Log4j 2** — Logging back-ends that write SLF4J log calls to the console, files or other destinations. §18.10
- **Logging** — Recording events with a level and logger name to configurable destinations (SLF4J, Logback, `java.util.logging`). §18.10
- **Lombok** — A library that generates boilerplate such as getters at compile time by hooking into `javac`. §17.12
- **Lomuto partition** — A simple partition scheme that keeps one `store` index; everything left of it is smaller than the pivot. §19.25
- **`long`** — The 64-bit signed integer primitive, about ±9.2 × $10^{18}$. §2.3
- **`LongAdder`** — A counter spread over several cells to avoid contention; faster than `AtomicLong` when many threads increment it. §14.10
- **Loop unrolling** — The JIT repeating a loop body several times per iteration to cut loop overhead. §16.8
- **Lowest common ancestor (LCA)** — The deepest tree node that has both given nodes beneath it (a node counts as its own descendant). §19.23
- **LRU cache** — A cache that evicts the least-recently-used entry; built with an access-ordered `LinkedHashMap`. §10.4
- **LTS release** — A long-term-support Java release (8, 11, 17, 21, 25) that vendors patch for years. §1.12

**M**

- **`main` method** — The program entry point: classically `public static void main(String[] args)`. §4.9
- **Manifest** — `META-INF/MANIFEST.MF` inside a JAR: metadata such as the `Main-Class` to run. §18.12
- **`Map`** — A key → value collection with unique keys; not a subtype of `Collection`. §10.4
- **Mark word** — The part of an object header that holds the identity hash code, lock state and GC age. §16.4
- **Mark-and-sweep** — GC that first marks every reachable object, then frees the rest. §16.5
- **Marker interface** — An interface with no methods that just tags a class, such as `Serializable`. §6.2
- **`Math`** — Utility class for arithmetic: `abs`, `pow`, `sqrt`, `round`, `floorMod`, `clamp`, `*Exact`. §7.5
- **Maven** — A build tool driven by `pom.xml`, with a fixed lifecycle of phases and a central repository. §18.2
- **Maven Central** — The main public repository from which Maven and Gradle download libraries. §18.1, §18.2
- **MDC (mapped diagnostic context)** — Per-thread key-value data, such as a request id, that the logging framework adds to every log line. §18.10

- **Megamorphic call** — A call site that has seen many different receiver classes, which the JIT can't inline well. §11.8, §16.8
- **Memoisation** — Caching a function's results by its arguments so each is computed only once — top-down dynamic programming. §19.19
- **Memory leak (Java)** — Objects that are no longer needed but stay reachable, so the GC can't free them. §16.11
- **Memory-mapped file** — A file mapped into the process's address space, so reading or writing memory reads or writes the file. §13.9
- **Merge sort** — Sorting by splitting the input in half, sorting each half and merging them; O(n log n) and stable. §19.25
- **Metaspace** — Native memory holding class metadata (replaced PermGen in Java 8). §16.3
- **Method** — A named block of code in a class that can take parameters and return a value. §4.1
- **Method overloading** — Several methods with the same name but different parameter lists, chosen at compile time. §4.3
- **Method overriding** — A subclass providing its own implementation of an inherited instance method, chosen at run time. §6.3
- **Method reference** — Shorthand for a lambda that calls one method: `String::length`, `System.out::println`, `ArrayList::new`. §11.4
- **Method signature** — A method's name plus its parameter types. §4.1
- **Microbenchmark** — A timing of a tiny piece of code; easy to get wrong without a harness such as JMH. §16.9
- **Minimum spanning tree** — The cheapest set of edges that connects every node of a weighted graph without a cycle (Kruskal's algorithm). §19.18
- **Mock** — A test double that records calls and returns programmed answers (e.g. with Mockito). §18.6
- **Mockito** — The most widely used Java mocking library: `mock`, `when(...).thenReturn`, `verify`. §18.6
- **Modular arithmetic** — Working with remainders after division by a fixed number m; answers are often reported "mod 1,000,000,007" to keep them small. §19.6, §19.27
- **Modular JAR** — A JAR that contains a `module-info.class`. §18.12
- **Module** — A named, self-describing group of packages declared in `module-info.java`. §16.12
- **Module import declaration** — `import module java.base;` (Java 25): imports every package a module exports. §17.10
- **Module path** — Where the JVM looks for modules (`--module-path`), as opposed to the class path. §16.12
- **Mojibake** — Garbled text produced by decoding bytes with the wrong charset. §13.7
- **Monitor (intrinsic lock)** — The lock every Java object has, used by `synchronized`, `wait` and `notify`. §14.6
- **Monotonic stack** — A stack kept in increasing or decreasing order by popping out-of-order items first; finds each "next greater element" in O(n). §19.12
- **Mounting / unmounting** — A virtual thread being attached to, or detached from, a carrier thread; blocking I/O unmounts it. §15.4
- **Multi-catch** — `catch (A \| B e)` — one handler for several unrelated exception types. §8.5
- **Multi-release JAR** — A JAR that holds different versions of some classes for different Java releases. §18.12
- **Mutable reduction** — Accumulating stream elements into a mutable container such as a list or map — what `collect` does. §12.5
- **Mutation testing** — Judging tests by planting small bugs ("mutants") and checking that the tests fail. §18.9
- **Mutual exclusion** — Letting only one thread at a time into a critical section. §14.6

**N**

- **NaN** — "Not a Number": the `double` result of undefined operations such as `0.0 / 0`; it is not even equal to itself. §2.11
- **Narrowing conversion** — Converting to a type with a smaller range (`long` → `int`); requires a cast and may lose information. §2.7

- **Native Image** — GraalVM's ahead-of-time compiler that turns a Java application into a fast-starting stand-alone executable. §18.12, §18.14
- **Native memory** — Memory the JVM uses outside the Java heap: metaspace, thread stacks, direct buffers, GC data. §16.3
- **Native Memory Tracking (NMT)** — A JVM option (`-XX:NativeMemoryTracking=summary`) that reports native memory use by area. §16.3
- **Natural order** — The order a class defines for itself by implementing `Comparable` (numbers ascending, strings alphabetically). §10.8
- **Nested class** — A class declared inside another; static nested or inner. §6.10
- **Netty** — A high-performance asynchronous networking framework for the JVM. §13.9
- **NIO.2** — The `java.nio.file` API (Java 7): `Path`, `Files`, `FileSystem`, `WatchService`. §13.1
- **Node** — One element of a linked structure (list, tree or graph) holding a value and references to its neighbours. §19.16, §19.22
- **Non-blocking** — An operation that returns immediately instead of making the thread wait, such as a CAS update. §14.10
- `null` — The reference value meaning "no object". §2.5
- `NullPointerException` **(NPE)** — Thrown when code uses a `null` reference as if it pointed to an object. §8.1

**O**

- **Object** — An instance of a class, with state (fields) and behaviour (methods), living on the heap. §5.1
- `Object` **class** — The root of every class hierarchy; defines `equals`, `hashCode`, `toString`, `getClass`, `wait`, `notify`. §6.2, §6.13
- **Object header** — The bookkeeping at the start of every object — mark word and class pointer: 12 bytes, or 8 with compact headers. §16.4
- **Observer / listener** — An object registered to be told about events; forgetting to unregister listeners is a classic memory leak. §16.11
- **OCP** — Oracle Certified Professional: the Java SE 21 Developer certification exam (1Z0-830). §20.18
- **Off-by-one error** — A loop or index that goes one step too far or stops one too short (`<=` instead of `<`). §3.10
- **Old generation** — The heap area for objects that survived several young collections. §16.5
- **On-stack replacement (OSR)** — Switching a long-running loop from interpreted to compiled code while it is still running. §16.8
- **OOP** — Object-oriented programming: organising code as objects that combine state and behaviour, using encapsulation, inheritance and polymorphism. §5.1
- **OpenJDK** — The open-source project and code base from which every mainstream Java distribution is built. §1.2
- **Operating system (OS)** — The software (Linux, Windows, macOS) that manages hardware, processes, memory and files for programs. §16.13
- **Operator** — A symbol that computes a value from operands, such as `+`, `==`, `&&` or `?:`. §2.8
- **Optimal substructure** — The best answer is built from the best answers to subproblems — one of the two conditions for dynamic programming. §19.19
- `Optional` — A container holding one value or none; a return type for "maybe no result". §11.7
- **Ordinal** — An enum constant's zero-based position in its declaration (`ordinal()`). §6.9
- `OutOfMemoryError` **(OOM)** — Thrown when the JVM can't allocate memory in the heap, metaspace or native memory. §16.3
- **Overlapping subproblems** — Plain recursion would solve the same subproblem many times — the other condition for dynamic programming. §19.19

**P**

- **P99** — The 99th-percentile latency: 99 % of operations finished at least this fast. §16.6
- **Package** — A namespace grouping related types, declared with `package`; mirrors the directory structure. §5.4

- **Package-private** — The default access (no modifier): visible within the same package only. §5.6
- **Page cache** — Operating-system memory holding recently read or written file data, so repeated reads skip the disk. §16.13
- **Page fault** — A CPU trap when a program touches memory that isn't currently mapped to RAM; the OS must load or allocate the page. §16.13
- **Palindrome** — Text (or a list) that reads the same forwards and backwards. §19.8
- **Parallel GC** — A throughput collector that uses many threads in stop-the-world pauses. §16.5
- **Parallel stream** — A stream whose work is split across the common `ForkJoinPool`; only worth it for large CPU-bound tasks. §12.8
- **Parallelism** — Tasks literally running at the same instant on different CPU cores; concurrency only requires them to overlap in time. §14.1
- **Parameterized test** — A test run once per set of arguments (`@ParameterizedTest` with a source). §18.5
- **Partition** — Rearranging an array around a pivot so smaller values end up on its left; the core step of quicksort and quickselect. §19.25
- **Pass-by-value** — Java always copies the argument value into the parameter; for objects, the value copied is the reference. §4.2
- `Path` — An NIO.2 object naming a file-system location; doesn't touch the disk by itself. §13.2
- **Path compression** — In union-find, pointing nodes at (or nearer to) the root during `find`, so later finds are almost O(1). §19.18
- **Path traversal** — An attack that uses `../` in a user-supplied file name to escape the intended directory. §13.2
- **Pattern matching** — Testing a value's shape and extracting parts in one step: type, record and unnamed patterns. §3.5, §3.6, §3.7
- **Pattern variable** — The variable a pattern binds when it matches, such as `s` in `o instanceof String s`. §3.5
- **PECS** — "Producer `extends`, consumer `super`": the wildcard rule for flexible generic APIs. §9.6
- `Period` — A `java.time` amount in years, months and days (e.g. `P1Y2M5D`). §7.9
- `Phaser` — A reusable barrier-like synchronizer whose number of parties can change between phases. §14.13
- **Pinning** — A virtual thread blocking without unmounting, holding its carrier; `synchronized` no longer pins since Java 24. §15.5
- **Pivot** — The value a partition splits around; picking it at random avoids quicksort's O(n²) worst case. §19.25
- **Platform thread** — A Java thread backed one-to-one by an OS thread. §15.4
- **Plugin (build)** — An add-on that gives Maven or Gradle a job to do, such as compiling, running tests or packaging. §18.2
- **Poison pill** — A special item put on a queue to tell its consumer to stop. §14.8, §14.12
- **Polymorphism** — One reference type, many run-time behaviours: a call runs the implementation of the object's actual class. §6.4
- **Precedence** — The order in which operators bind (`*` before `+`, `&&` before `\|\|`). §2.9
- **Precise rethrow** — `catch (Exception e) { throw e; }` keeps the narrower checked types the `try` can actually throw. §8.5
- **Prefix sum** — Running totals where `prefix[i]` is the sum of the first i elements, so any range sum costs one subtraction. §19.11
- `PreparedStatement` — A pre-compiled JDBC statement with `?` parameters; prevents SQL injection. §18.11
- **Preview feature** — A complete feature that may still change; needs `--enable-preview` on `javac` and `java`. §1.12, §17.1
- **Primitive stream** — `IntStream`, `LongStream` or `DoubleStream`, which avoid boxing and add `sum`/`average`. §12.6
- **Primitive type** — One of the eight built-in value types: `byte`, `short`, `int`, `long`, `float`, `double`, `char`, `boolean`. §2.3
- `PriorityQueue` — A binary-heap queue that always removes the smallest element (by natural order or a comparator). §10.6

- **`private`** — Access modifier: visible only inside the declaring top-level class. §5.6
- **Process** — A running program with its own memory; the threads inside it share that memory. §14.1, §16.13
- **Producer–consumer** — One set of threads creating work items and another processing them, joined by a shared (usually blocking) queue. §14.12
- **Profiling** — Measuring where a running program spends CPU time or allocates memory (JFR, async-profiler). §16.10
- **Promotion (numeric)** — Automatic widening of `byte`, `short` and `char` to `int` (or to the wider operand type) in arithmetic. §2.7
- **`Properties`** — A key=value configuration map loaded from `.properties` files. §13.11
- **`protected`** — Access modifier: visible in the package and to subclasses. §5.6
- **Pseudo-random number generator** — An algorithm whose output looks random but is fully determined by its seed. §7.12
- **Pure function** — A function whose result depends only on its arguments and that has no side effects. §11.8

**Q**

- **Quarkus / Micronaut** — Cloud-native Java frameworks designed for fast start-up and low memory. §18.14, §20.18
- **Queue** — A collection that hands elements out in arrival order (FIFO): `offer` adds at the tail, `poll` removes from the head. §10.6
- **Quickselect** — Finding the k-th smallest element by partitioning and continuing on one side only; O(n) on average. §19.25
- **Quicksort** — Sorting by partitioning around a pivot and recursing on both sides; O(n log n) on average. §19.25

**R**

- **Race condition** — A result that depends on the timing of threads, e.g. lost updates from `count++`. §14.5
- **Raw type** — A generic type used without type arguments (`List`); disables generic type checking. §9.7
- **Reachability** — An object is live if a chain of references leads to it from a GC root. §16.5
- **Read-modify-write** — Reading a value, computing a new one and writing it back (`count++`); not atomic unless protected. §14.5
- **`ReadWriteLock`** — A lock pair allowing many concurrent readers or one writer. §14.9
- **Record** — A concise immutable data carrier (Java 16) with generated constructor, accessors, `equals`, `hashCode`, `toString`. §6.8
- **Record pattern** — A pattern that deconstructs a record: `case Point(int x, int y)` (Java 21). §3.7
- **Recurrence** — A formula that defines each answer from earlier ones, such as J(n) = (J(n − 1) + k) mod n. §19.19, §19.27
- **Recursion** — A method calling itself; needs a base case to stop. §4.5
- **Red-black tree** — A self-balancing binary search tree that keeps every operation O(log n); `TreeMap` and `TreeSet` use one. §10.4
- **Reduction** — Combining stream elements into one result with `reduce` or a collector. §12.4
- **Reentrant** — A lock its holder can acquire again without blocking itself, as `synchronized` and `ReentrantLock` allow. §14.6
- **`ReentrantLock`** — An explicit reentrant lock with `tryLock`, timeouts, fairness and conditions. §14.9
- **Refactoring** — Restructuring code to make it clearer without changing what it does; tests make it safe. §18.4, §18.9
- **Reference type** — Any non-primitive type; variables hold references to objects (or `null`). §2.5
- **Reflection** — Inspecting and using classes, methods and fields at run time (`getClass()`, `java.lang.reflect`). §16.2
- **Region (G1)** — One of the equal-sized blocks G1 divides the heap into; each region is eden, survivor, old or humongous at any time. §16.5

- **Regular expression** — A pattern language for matching text, used by `split`, `replaceAll`, `matches`, `Pattern`. §7.2
- **Reifiable type** — A type fully known at run time (`String`, `List<?>`, `int[]`); `List<String>` is not, because of erasure. §9.8
- **Rejection policy** — What a `ThreadPoolExecutor` does with a task when its queue is full and no thread is free — throw, run it in the caller, or drop it. §14.11
- **Relative / absolute path** — An absolute path starts at the file-system root; a relative path is resolved against the current directory. §13.2
- **REPL** — Read-eval-print loop: an interactive prompt such as `jshell`. §1.9
- **Resident set size (RSS)** — The physical memory a process actually occupies, as reported by the operating system. §16.10, §16.13
- **Resource leak** — Failing to close a file, socket or connection; prevented by try-with-resources. §8.6, §13.13
- **REST API** — A web API in which URLs name resources and HTTP methods (GET, POST …) act on them, usually exchanging JSON. §18.14
- **Reverse Polish Notation** — Postfix notation in which each operator follows its operands (`3 4 +`), evaluated with a stack. §19.12
- **RMI** — Remote Method Invocation: an old Java API for calling methods in another JVM, built on serialization. §13.10
- `Runnable` — A task interface with `void run()` and no result. §14.2
- `RuntimeException` — The superclass of unchecked exceptions. §8.2

**S**

- **Safepoint** — A point at which all Java threads can be paused safely, for example for parts of a garbage collection. §16.5
- **Scalar replacement** — Replacing a non-escaping object's fields with local variables so it's never allocated. §16.8
- **Scale (`BigDecimal`)** — The number of digits after the decimal point; `2.0` and `2.00` have different scales. §7.7
- `Scanner` — A `java.util` class that reads and parses console or file input token by token. §2.13
- `ScheduledExecutorService` — An executor that runs tasks after a delay or repeatedly at a fixed rate. §14.11
- **Scheduler** — The part of the OS (or, for virtual threads, of the JVM) that decides which thread runs on which core next. §15.4, §16.13
- **Scoped value** — An immutable value bound for the duration of a call and readable by code it invokes (final in Java 25). §15.6
- **SDKMAN!** — A command-line tool for installing and switching between JDK versions. §1.4
- **Sealed class** — A class or interface (Java 17) that lists its *permitted subclasses* with `permits`. §6.7
- `SecureRandom` — A random-number generator strong enough for passwords, keys and tokens. §7.12
- **Seed** — The starting value of a pseudo-random generator; the same seed reproduces the same sequence. §7.12
- **Selector** — The value a `switch` examines. §3.2
- `Semaphore` — A synchronizer handing out a fixed number of permits to limit concurrent access. §14.13
- **Sequenced collection** — Java 21 interfaces (`SequencedCollection`, `SequencedSet`, `SequencedMap`) with `getFirst`, `getLast`, `reversed`. §10.11
- **Serial GC** — A single-threaded, stop-the-world collector for small heaps. §16.5
- **Serialization** — Converting objects to bytes with `ObjectOutputStream`; risky with untrusted data. §13.10
- `serialVersionUID` — The version number checked when deserialising a `Serializable` class. §13.10
- `Set` — A collection with no duplicate elements. §10.3
- **Shadowing** — A local variable or parameter hiding a field with the same name; use `this.name` to reach the field. §5.2

- **Shallow immutability** — Fields can't be reassigned, but the objects they refer to may still be mutable (true of records). §5.9, §6.8
- **Shebang** — A first line such as `#!/usr/bin/java --source 25` that lets a Java source file run as a Unix script. §1.10
- **Shenandoah** — A low-pause OpenJDK collector that compacts concurrently. §16.5
- **Short-circuit evaluation** — `&&` and `\|\|` skip the right operand when the left decides the result; also short-circuiting stream operations. §2.8, §12.4
- **Side effect** — Anything a function does besides returning a value: changing a field, printing, writing a file. §11.8
- **Sieve of Eratosthenes** — Finding every prime up to n by crossing out the multiples of each prime in turn. §19.27
- **SIGKILL** — The Unix signal that ends a process at once, with no chance to clean up (sent, for example, by the OOM killer). §16.13
- **SIMD** — Single instruction, multiple data: one CPU instruction that works on several numbers at once. §16.8
- **Single-file source launch** — Running `java Hello.java` without a separate compile step (Java 11). §1.10
- **Singleton** — A class with exactly one instance, often written as an `enum` with one constant. §5.3
- **SLF4J** — Simple Logging Facade for Java: a logging API with pluggable backends such as Logback. §18.10
- **Sliding window** — Keeping a running summary of a contiguous range while moving its ends forward, so subarray problems take O(n). §19.9
- **SNAPSHOT version** — A Maven version ending in `-SNAPSHOT`, meaning "work in progress — may change". §18.1
- **SOLID** — Five object-oriented design principles: single responsibility, open/closed, Liskov substitution, interface segregation, dependency inversion. §20.18
- **Space complexity** — How much extra memory an algorithm needs as its input grows, in Big-O terms. §19.7
- `Spliterator` — The splittable iterator behind every stream, which divides the work for parallel streams. §12.2
- **Spring Boot** — The most widely used Java framework for back-end services, with auto-configuration and starters. §18.14
- **Spy** — A test double that wraps a real object and records calls, letting you stub only some methods. §18.6
- **SQL** — Structured Query Language: the language for querying and changing relational databases. §18.11
- **SQL injection** — An attack in which user input is pasted into SQL text and runs as commands; `PreparedStatement` parameters prevent it. §18.11
- **Stable sort** — A sort that keeps equal elements in their original relative order. §10.8, §19.5
- **Stack (data structure)** — A LIFO collection: `push` adds on top and `pop` removes from the top; use `ArrayDeque`, not `Stack`. §10.6, §19.4
- **Stack (JVM)** — Per-thread memory of frames for active method calls, holding locals and partial results. §16.3
- **Stack trace** — The list of method frames active when an exception was created, newest first. §8.9
- **Stack unwinding** — An exception travelling up the call stack, abandoning each frame until a matching `catch` is found. §8.1
- `StackOverflowError` — Thrown when a thread's stack is exhausted, usually by runaway recursion. §4.5, §16.3
- `StampedLock` — A lock with an optimistic-read mode for read-mostly data; not reentrant. §14.9
- **Standard streams** — `System.in`, `System.out` and `System.err`: the input, output and error channels every program starts with. §13.8
- **Starvation** — A thread never gets the CPU or lock it needs because others always win. §15.9
- **Stateless / stateful operation** — A stateless stream step (`map`, `filter`) looks at one element at a time; a stateful one (`sorted`, `distinct`) must remember others. §12.3

- `static` — Belonging to the class rather than to an instance; one copy shared by all. §5.5
- **Static nested class** — A nested class declared `static`; it has no enclosing instance. §6.10
- **Stop-the-world (STW) pause** — A GC phase during which all application threads are paused. §16.5
- **Stream** — A lazy, one-shot pipeline of operations over a source of elements (`java.util.stream`). §12.1
- `String` — An immutable sequence of UTF-16 characters. §2.12, §7.1
- **String pool** — The JVM table of shared `String` objects for literals and interned strings. §7.1
- **String templates** — A preview feature in Java 21 and 22 that was withdrawn in Java 23. §17.8
- `StringBuilder` — A mutable, unsynchronised character buffer for building strings efficiently. §7.3
- **Strong encapsulation** — Since Java 17 JDK internals are inaccessible by default; `--add-opens` is required to reach them. §17.3
- **Structured concurrency** — Treating a group of concurrent subtasks as one unit (`StructuredTaskScope`); still preview in Java 25. §15.7
- **Structured logging** — Logging events as named fields (often JSON) that machines can search, rather than only free text. §18.10
- **Stub** — A test double that returns canned answers. §18.6
- **Subarray / subsequence** — A subarray (or substring) is a **contiguous** slice (no gaps); a subsequence keeps the original order but may skip elements. §19.9, §19.19
- `super` — Refers to the parent class: `super.method()` calls the parent's version, `super(...)` its constructor. §6.1
- **Suppressed exception** — An exception from `close()` attached to the primary exception in try-with-resources. §8.6
- **Surefire** — The Maven plugin that runs unit tests (its sibling Failsafe runs integration tests). §18.2
- **Surrogate pair** — Two `char`s encoding one Unicode character outside the Basic Multilingual Plane (many emoji). §7.2
- **Survivor space** — Young-generation areas to which objects that survived a collection are copied before promotion to the old generation. §16.5
- `switch` **expression** — A `switch` that yields a value (Java 14), using arrow labels or `yield`. §3.3
- `synchronized` — Keyword that acquires an object's monitor for a method or block, giving mutual exclusion and visibility. §14.6
- **Synchronizer** — A coordination object such as a latch, barrier, semaphore or phaser. §14.13
- **System call** — A request from a program to the operating-system kernel, such as reading a file. §16.13

**T**

- **Tabulation** — Bottom-up dynamic programming: filling a table in an order where every entry's dependencies are already computed. §19.19
- **Template Method pattern** — A base class fixes the steps of an algorithm and lets subclasses fill in some of them. §6.5
- `TemporalAdjusters` — Ready-made date adjustments such as "last day of the month" or "next Monday". §7.9
- **Terminal operation** — The stream operation that produces a result and triggers execution (`collect`, `count`, `forEach`). §12.4
- **Ternary operator** — `cond ? a : b` — the conditional expression. §2.8
- **Test double** — Any stand-in for a real collaborator in a test: dummy, stub, fake, spy or mock. §18.6
- **Testcontainers** — A library that starts real services (databases, message brokers) in throwaway Docker containers for tests. §18.9
- **Test-driven development (TDD)** — Writing a failing test first, then the code to make it pass, then tidying up. §18.9
- **Text block** — A multi-line string literal delimited by `"""` (Java 15). §2.12
- `this` — A reference to the current object; `this(...)` calls another constructor. §5.2, §5.3
- **Thread** — An independent path of execution within a process, sharing the heap with other threads. §14.1

- **Thread confinement** — Keeping data reachable by only one thread, so it needs no locking. §14.14
- **Thread dump** — A snapshot of every thread's state and stack; shows deadlocks. §16.10
- **Thread pool** — A set of reusable worker threads that execute submitted tasks. §14.11
- **Thread priority** — A hint from 1 to 10 for the scheduler; the operating system may ignore it. §15.9
- `ThreadLocal` — A variable with an independent value per thread. §15.6
- **Thread-per-request** — A server model that gives every request its own thread; affordable at scale with virtual threads. §15.4
- `ThreadPoolExecutor` — The configurable thread-pool class behind most `Executors` factory methods. §14.11
- **Thread-safe** — Behaving correctly when used by several threads at once without extra coordination by callers. §14.1, §14.14
- **Throughput** — Work completed per unit of time — requests per second, or for a GC the share of time not spent collecting. §16.5, System Design Fundamentals
- `throw` / `throws` — `throw` raises an exception; `throws` in a method signature declares checked exceptions it may raise. §8.3, §8.7
- `Throwable` — The root class of everything that can be thrown: `Error` and `Exception`. §8.2
- **Tiered compilation** — Running code in the interpreter, then C1, then C2 as it gets hotter. §1.7
- **Time slice** — The short period a thread runs before the scheduler may switch the core to another thread. §16.13
- **Time zone** — A region's rules for its offset from UTC, including daylight saving, such as `Europe/Paris`. §7.10
- **TimSort** — The stable merge sort used by `Arrays.sort` and `List.sort` for objects; very fast on partly sorted data. §19.5
- **TLAB** — Thread-local allocation buffer: a private chunk of eden from which one thread allocates without locking. §16.5
- **TLB** — Translation lookaside buffer: the CPU's cache of virtual-to-physical address translations. §16.13
- **TLS** — Transport Layer Security: the encryption behind HTTPS. §17.10
- **Toolchain** — A build-tool setting that picks the exact JDK used to compile and test, independent of the JDK running the build. §18.3
- **Topological sort** — Ordering a DAG's nodes so every edge points forward — prerequisites before the tasks that need them. §19.17
- `toString` — Returns a text representation; `Object`'s default is `ClassName@hash`. §6.13
- **Transaction** — A group of database changes that succeed or fail together (`commit` or `rollback`). §18.11
- **Transitive dependency** — A library you get indirectly because one of your dependencies needs it. §18.1, §18.2
- **Treeification** — `HashMap` turning a bucket of more than 8 entries into a small red-black tree (Java 8+, once the table has ≥ 64 buckets). §10.5
- `TreeMap` / `TreeSet` — Red-black-tree map/set kept in sorted order, O(log n), with navigation methods such as `floorKey`. §10.4, §10.3
- **Trie** — A prefix tree that stores strings character by character, so prefix lookups cost O(length of the prefix). §19.21
- **try-with-resources** — `try (Resource r = …)`, which closes every declared `AutoCloseable` automatically, in reverse order. §8.6
- **Two pointers** — Two indexes or references ("pointers", such as `left` and `right`) moving through data in a coordinated way, so one pass replaces a nested loop. §19.8
- **Two's complement** — How Java stores signed integers: the top bit is the sign and −x equals `~x + 1`. §2.10, §19.26
- **Type erasure (erasure)** — Compiling generics by checking types and then removing type arguments, inserting casts. §9.7
- **Type inference** — The compiler deducing types (`var`, diamond, generic method arguments, lambda parameters). §2.6, §9.4

- **Type parameter** — A placeholder type such as `T` in `class Box<T>`. §9.2
- **Type pattern** — A pattern that tests a type and binds a variable: `instanceof String s`, `case Integer i`. §3.5
- **Type witness** — An explicit type argument written before a generic method's name, e.g. `Comparator.<int[]>comparingInt(...)`. §9.4, §19.5

**U**

- **Unchecked exception** — `RuntimeException`, `Error` and their subclasses — not checked by the compiler. §8.2
- **Unchecked warning** — A compiler warning that a generic operation can't be type-checked (raw types, unchecked casts). §9.8
- `UncheckedIOException` — An unchecked wrapper for `IOException`, used inside lambdas and streams. §13.4
- **Unicode** — The universal character set; Java strings use the UTF-16 encoding of it. §7.2
- **Union-find (disjoint set union)** — A structure that tracks which elements belong to the same group and merges groups in nearly O(1) per operation. §19.18
- **Unit test** — A fast test of one small piece of code — a method or a class — in isolation. §18.4, §18.9
- **Unmodifiable collection** — A collection whose mutators throw `UnsupportedOperationException`, such as `List.of`. §10.10
- **Unnamed module** — The module that holds everything loaded from the class path. §16.12
- **Unnamed variable** `_` — An underscore for a variable or pattern you don't use (Java 22). §3.7, §17.7
- `UnsupportedOperationException` — Thrown by an operation a collection or object doesn't support. §10.10
- **UTC** — Coordinated Universal Time: the world reference time, with no time-zone or daylight-saving shifts. §7.10
- **UTF-16** — The encoding Java strings use: each character is one or two 16-bit `char`s. §2.3, §7.2
- **UTF-8** — A variable-length encoding using 1–4 bytes per character; the Java default charset since 18. §13.7

**V**

- **Value object** — A small immutable object defined only by its values (an amount of money, a date range); records fit well. §6.8, §18.6
- `var` **(local variable type inference)** — Java 10: the compiler infers a local variable's type from its initializer. §2.6
- **Varargs** — A parameter `T... values` accepting zero or more arguments as an array. §4.4
- **Vector API** — An incubating API for SIMD calculations — one instruction applied to many numbers at once. §17.11
- **Virtual memory** — Each process sees its own large address space, which the OS maps onto physical RAM page by page. §16.13
- **Virtual thread** — A lightweight thread (Java 21) scheduled by the JVM onto carrier threads; cheap enough to create one per task. §15.4
- **Visibility (memory)** — Whether one thread's writes are guaranteed to be seen by another. §14.7, §15.8
- **VisualVM / Eclipse MAT / async-profiler** — Free diagnostic tools: VisualVM monitors a running JVM, Eclipse MAT analyses heap dumps, async-profiler samples CPU and allocations into flame graphs. §16.10
- `volatile` — A field modifier guaranteeing visibility and ordering of reads and writes, but not atomic compound actions. §14.7

**W**

- `wait` / `notify` — `Object` methods for guarded blocks; must be called holding the object's monitor. §14.8
- **Wait set** — The threads waiting in `wait()` on an object's monitor until they are notified. §14.8
- **Warm-up** — The start-up period while the JVM loads classes and the JIT compiles hot code; timings taken then are misleadingly slow. §16.9

- **`WatchService`** — The NIO.2 API that reports files being created, changed or deleted in a directory. §13.9
- **Weakly consistent iterator** — A concurrent-collection iterator that never throws CME and may or may not show concurrent updates. §14.12
- **Week-based year** — `YYYY` in a date pattern: the year a week belongs to, which differs from the calendar year `yyyy` around New Year. §7.11
- **Widening conversion** — Automatic conversion to a type with a larger range (`int` → `long` → `double`). §2.7
- **Wildcard** — `?` in a generic type: `List<?>`, `List<? extends T>`, `List<? super T>`. §9.6
- **Work stealing** — Idle threads taking tasks from the back of busy threads' queues, as `ForkJoinPool` does. §15.3
- **Wrapper class** — The object form of a primitive: `Integer`, `Long`, `Double`, `Character`, `Boolean`, … §7.6

**X**

- **XML** — Extensible Markup Language: a tag-based text format, used for example by Maven's `pom.xml`. §18.2

**Y**

- **`yield`** — Returns a value from a block inside a `switch` expression. §3.3
- **Young generation** — The heap area (eden plus survivor spaces) where new objects are allocated; collected often and cheaply. §16.5

**Z**

- **Zero-copy** — Moving data between files and sockets without copying it through the Java heap (e.g. `transferTo`). §13.9
- **ZGC** — A scalable low-latency collector with sub-millisecond pauses; generational-only since Java 24. §16.5
- **`ZonedDateTime`** — A date-time with a time-zone region, aware of daylight-saving rules. §7.10

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## Chapter TL;DR

- **Types**: eight primitives with fixed sizes (`int` ±2.1 × $10^9$, `long` ±9.2 × $10^{18}$, `char` 0–65 535); integer overflow wraps silently; `0.1 + 0.2 != 0.3`; money in `BigDecimal` built from strings.
- **Equality**: `==` compares references for objects; use `equals` — the `Integer` cache (−128…127) and the string pool only make `==` *look* right.
- **Modern syntax**: switch expressions, pattern matching with guards, record patterns and `_`, sealed types for exhaustive switches, records for data, `var` for locals, text blocks.
- **Collections**: `ArrayList` and `HashMap` by default, `ArrayDeque` for stacks and queues, `TreeMap` for order and ranges, `LinkedHashMap` for LRU; `List.of` is unmodifiable and rejects `null`.
- **Functional and streams**: `Supplier` / `Consumer` / `Predicate` / `Function`; streams are lazy and one-shot; `groupingBy`, `partitioningBy`, `toMap` (duplicates throw); gatherers in 24; `Optional` only as a return type.
- **Exceptions**: checked = recoverable and declared, unchecked = bugs; try-with-resources closes in reverse and keeps close failures as suppressed; never `return` from `finally`.
- **Concurrency**: `synchronized`/locks for mutual exclusion, `volatile` for visibility only, atomics and `ConcurrentHashMap` for counters and caches, `CompletableFuture` for composition, virtual threads for blocking I/O at scale; happens-before decides visibility.
- **JVM**: heap, stacks, metaspace, code cache; G1 by default, ZGC for low latency; `-Xmx`, `-Xlog:gc*`, heap dumps on OOM; `jcmd`, JFR, `jstack` to diagnose.
- **Versions**: 17 sealed · 21 virtual threads, pattern `switch`, record patterns, sequenced collections · 22 `_`, FFM · 24 gatherers · 25 compact source files, module imports, flexible constructors, scoped values. Structured concurrency is still preview.

- **Tools**: `mvn clean verify` / `./gradlew build`, JUnit + Mockito + AssertJ, SLF4J for logging, `PreparedStatement` for SQL.
- **Next**: Spring Boot (or Jakarta EE, Quarkus), Kotlin if you like, and the LLD, SQL and DDIA notes — then build something real.